

Final External Evaluation

Better Migration Management Programme Phase III

Final Evaluation Report

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CONTENTS

List of acronyms.....	3
Executive Summary.....	4
1. Background and context.....	8
1.1 Regional migration context	8
1.2 Better Migration Management (BMM) Programme.....	9
1.3 Evaluation Background.....	12
2. Evaluation approach and methodology	13
2.1. Evaluation Framework.....	13
2.2. Data collection.....	14
2.3. Data analysis and limitations	15
3. Evaluation findings.....	17
3.1. Relevance.....	17
3.2. Coherence	19
3.3. Effectiveness.....	21
3.4. Efficiency	35
3.5. Impact.....	39
3.6. Sustainability	40
4. Conclusions.....	42
5. Recommendations	44

LIST OF ACRONYMS

Abbreviation	Definition
AWP	Annual Work Plan
BCNM	National Coordination office for Migration in Djibouti
BCP	Border Crossing Point
BMM	Better Migration Management
CSO	Civil Society Organization
DSA	Daily Subsistence Allowances
EAC	East African Community
EHoA	East and Horn of Africa
EUTF	European Union's Trust Fund for Africa
GBV	Gender-Based Violence
GCM	Global Compact for Migration
GIZ	Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit
IBG	Integrated Border Governance
IBM	Integrated Border Management
IBMC	Inter-Agency Border Management Committees
ICA	Immigration and Citizenship Agency
ICS	Immigration and Citizenship Services
IGAD	Intergovernmental Authority on Development
IOM	International Organization for Migration
MHPSS	Mental health and psychosocial support
MIDAS	Migration Information and Data Analysis System
NCM	National Coordination Mechanism
NMP	National Migration Policy
NPC	National Partnership Coalitions
NRM	National Referral Mechanism
OCA	Organizational Capacity Assessment
OECD	Organisation of Economic Cooperation and Development
OSBP	One Stop Border Posts
RO	Regional Office
RPC	Regional Partnership Coalition
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures
TiP	Trafficking in Persons
ToT	Training of Trainers
TVET	Technical and vocational education and training
UN	United Nations
UNEG	United Nations Evaluation Group
UNODC	United Nations Office on Drugs and Crimes
VoT	Victims of Trafficking

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The **East and Horn of Africa** is a region that serves as a point of origin, transit, and destination for migration. Here, migration arises from the adverse effects of climate change, conflict and instability, exacerbating socioeconomic challenges. Migrants in the region are highly vulnerable to exploitation, trafficking and other dangers related to migration in the region.¹

In 2016, the International Organization for Migration (IOM), alongside the British Council, CIVIPOL, GIZ and United Nations Office on Drugs and Crimes (UNODC), launched the **Better Migration Management (BMM)** programme in Djibouti, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Kenya, Somalia, South Sudan, Sudan and Uganda. The programme was funded by the European Union (EU) Trust Fund for Africa and the German Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development. Since 2016, BMM has witnessed three phases.

The **overall objective** of BMM is to enable national authorities and institutions to manage safe, orderly and regular migration by applying a human rights-based approach and addressing human trafficking and smuggling of migrants. The programme comprises **three interconnected components**:

1. Strengthening migration governance to create legal frameworks for regionally coordinated migration management;
2. Supporting institutions to combat human trafficking and smuggling of migrants through integrated border governance; and
3. Protecting victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants.

GIZ serves as the lead implementer of the programme, contracting IOM to implement activities under each of these three components. The **third phase** of the BMM programme commenced in October 2022 and is scheduled to conclude in March 2025, with the majority of activities completed by December 2024.

IOM commissioned an **independent final evaluation** to assess its contributions under Phase III. This evaluation, conducted by two external consultants, examines the **relevance, coherence, effectiveness, efficiency, impact, and sustainability** of IOM's interventions. It applies a theory-based approach, using the Theory of Change as a foundation and aligning with OECD DAC evaluation criteria and UN Evaluation Group (UNEG) norms and standards

The evaluation employed a **mixed-methods approach**, including desk research and key informant interviews. Desk research was conducted in two phases to ensure data triangulation, while **40 online interviews** were carried out with IOM staff, implementing partners, national government stakeholders, and civil society organizations.

Findings

The evaluation found that IOM's activities under the Phase III of BMM programme were **highly relevant** to the migration challenges in the East and Horn of Africa region, effectively addressing issues such as irregular migration, human trafficking, and weak institutional capacities. IOM's **adaptability to evolving contexts**, including conflicts and shifting political landscapes, ensured continued relevance. While alignment with initial

¹ <https://crisisresponse.iom.int/response/regional-migrant-response-plan-horn-africa-yemen-and-southern-africa-2024>

programme objectives remained strong, adjustments were necessary to accommodate changing government priorities.

IOM's Regional Office **effectively coordinated** IOM activities, ensuring smooth multi-country implementation and responsiveness through a well-structured management approach and country focal points. Internally, there was **strong coherence** with other IOM projects and frameworks which facilitated cost-sharing and expanded reach. The external coordination with other implementing partners fell primarily under GIZ responsibility as lead implementer of the BMM programme. In this regard, the dual role of GIZ as both a grant giver and an implementing partner added additional complexity in coordination and communication, but active and cooperative relationship between GIZ and the IOM Regional Office helped mitigate potential challenges.

IOM **largely met or exceeded Phase III programme targets**, contributing to strengthened migration governance, improved integrated border governance, and enhanced protection services for vulnerable migrants. Despite financial constraints, bureaucratic delays, and political instability, the programme effectively utilized resources, though initial delays led to spending pressures in later phases.

Sustainability remains a key concern, as continued reliance on donor funding poses risks to maintaining programme achievements. Ensuring national ownership and securing budget allocations will be critical in BMM Phase IV to sustain progress. The transition to BMM Phase IV presents an opportunity to reinforce sustainability measures, but risks remain if funding gaps and staffing disparities are not addressed. BMM Phase IV's lower budget and potentially stricter scope will make sustained investment and coordination even more critical.

The table below briefly summarizes key findings along the summarized evaluation questions:

Evaluation criteria and questions	Findings
Relevance	
Were IOM activities relevant to the needs of the countries and their stakeholders?	IOM activities under BMM Phase III were highly relevant as they addressed key migration challenges in the East and Horn of Africa, including irregular migration, human trafficking, weak migration governance, and limited protection mechanisms for vulnerable migrants. National stakeholders confirmed that IOM's interventions aligned with country priorities and regional migration frameworks.
Did IOM's activities remain valid and pertinent as originally planned, or were they subsequently modified?	While IOM's activities remained largely aligned with the original objectives, some modifications were made in response to emerging challenges. For instance, the conflict in Sudan necessitated a shift in focus toward strengthening border management in South Sudan, and national government priorities required adjustments, such as reallocating funding from the Migration Information and Data Analysis System (MIDAS) to an e-visa system in Djibouti.
Coherence	
To what extent IOM activities were internally aligned with other efforts of IOM?	IOM demonstrated strong internal coherence by integrating BMM activities with other migration-related programs, enabling cost-sharing and cross-program collaboration. Examples include co-funding initiatives and the alignment of BMM with the Regional Migrant Response Plan to ensure consistency in migration governance efforts.

To what extent IOM activities were externally aligned with efforts and organizations outside IOM?	IOM effectively coordinated with BMM implementing partners (GIZ, UNODC, CIVIPOL, and British Council) and aligned its work with regional actors. No significant overlaps were identified or mentioned by interview partners.
Effectiveness	
Did IOM deliver what it was supposed to do?	IOM met or exceeded most of its key performance indicators under the BMM Phase III results framework, particularly in enhancing migration governance, strengthening institutional capacities, and improving victim protection. Some outputs, such as training border officials and supporting policy development, surpassed initial targets.
What hindered the implementation of the programme and achievement of outcomes?	Several factors hindered implementation, including security challenges (e.g., armed conflicts and political instability in Ethiopia, and Somalia), delayed signing of the contractual agreement between IOM and GIZ, procurement bottlenecks, and changing government priorities that affected planned activities. Additionally, limited financial and human resources in some IOM country offices slowed down implementation.
Efficiency	
To what extent were IOM activities financially efficient?	While IOM successfully leveraged cost-sharing and maximized available resources, delayed contract signing at the start of Phase III led to low burn rates initially and a rush to spend remaining funds toward the end. Despite this, no major inefficiencies in resource allocation were identified.
To what extent was IOM efficient in terms of coordination and reporting?	Internal coordination was strong, with IOM's Regional Office for the East, Horn and Southern Africa as the management site, organising regular meetings between regional and country offices. Reporting mechanisms were well-structured and described as straightforward and manageable by staff despite frequent reporting requirements from the donor. Externally, some joint activities were conducted with other implementing partners, but further integration could be explored by GIZ as lead implementer to align partners' implementation timelines and create further synergies.
Impact	
What initial signs of impact of IOM activities can be noted?	IOM's activities have contributed to strengthened migration governance, with progress in policy development in several countries. Cross-border cooperation mechanisms, such as Inter-Agency Border Management Committees (IBMCs) in Somalia, have improved operational coordination. Additionally, community awareness campaigns and protection services have enhanced support for vulnerable migrants, though long-term impacts remain difficult to measure at this stage.
Sustainability	
To what extent the achievements of IOM activities are likely to be sustained long-term?	While IOM has helped institutionalize migration management through policies, training, and capacity-building, sustainability remains a concern. Many governments still rely on external funding, and gaps in national budgetary commitments threaten long-term program viability. The expected funding gap between BMM Phase III and IV could also disrupt continuity, potentially leading to staff turnover and loss of institutional knowledge.

Recommendations

To maintain and strengthen the effectiveness, efficiency, and sustainability of future IOM activities, especially under the BMM Phase IV, the evaluation recommends IOM to maintain its effective internal coordination structure with the Regional Office as the primary coordination and management site and maintain focal points in each BMM country to ensure localized responsiveness. Additionally, procurement and financial coordination should be reviewed to streamline processes and prevent delays.

To maintain programmatic momentum, transition plans should be developed to minimize staffing disruptions between programme phases, and multi-year funding commitments should be sought from donors to enhance stability. Based on experience from previous phases, IOM should anticipate potential contractual delays and changing national priorities during BMM Phase IV and plan its budgetary spending accordingly, to prevent spending pressures at the end of the project cycle.

To promote sustainability, national governments should gradually take on greater ownership and responsibility for migration governance efforts. A co-funding model could be introduced, where IOM contributes resources while national governments also commit financial or personnel support toward BMM objectives. This collaborative approach would ensure joint ownership and accountability, with both parties working together to achieve the goals and ensure sustainability. Additionally, capacity-building initiatives should be embedded within national institutions to institutionalize knowledge transfer. Formal communication channels with stakeholders could be strengthened to reduce delays. Given that Phase IV will likely be the final phase of the BMM programme, the focus should be on consolidating existing achievements rather than launching new lengthy policy initiatives. This approach will ensure resources are used effectively, maximize impact, and maintain continuity in policy implementation.

Section 5 describes the recommendations below in more detail and offers a list of actions for their implementation:

- **Recommendation 1:** Maintain a strong internal coordination structure and retain qualified staff to ensure efficiency and effective implementation of activities under BMM Phase IV.
- **Recommendation 2:** Enhance internal cross-country cooperation and synergies with implementing partners
- **Recommendation 3:** Ensure continuity between BMM programme phases.
- **Recommendation 4:** Strengthen procurement and financial coordination to streamline processes and prevent delays.
- **Recommendation 5:** Strengthen national ownership, commitment, and capacities.
- **Recommendation 6:** For BMM Phase IV, finalize ongoing policy processes and consolidate established activities instead of starting new lengthy initiatives, ensuring regional and cross-border initiatives are prioritized.

1. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

1.1 REGIONAL MIGRATION CONTEXT

Migration in the East and Horn of Africa (EHoA) is shaped by a complex mix of socio-economic, political, and environmental factors. According to the state of migration report for 2022, the region hosts approximately 8.5 million international migrants, with a significant majority (64%) being refugees and asylum seekers. In total, 22.3 million individuals in the region are displaced, including 16.9 million internally displaced persons. Forced displacement remains the predominant driver of migration, particularly in countries such as South Sudan, Uganda, Ethiopia, Somalia, Eritrea, and Kenya, which simultaneously serve as both sources and hosts of refugees. The scale of displacement is fuelled by persistent conflicts, governance challenges, and climate-related disasters, making Eastern Africa **one of the most migration-affected regions** globally.

In addition to forced displacement, both regular and irregular labour migration play significant roles in shaping migration patterns. However, irregular migration is particularly prevalent due to the presence of well-established smuggling and trafficking networks, which take advantage of weak border controls and governance structures.² These criminal networks not only exploit vulnerable migrants but also contribute to corruption within government institutions, undermining migration management efforts.³ Furthermore, the region's exposure to climate shocks has exacerbated food insecurity and displacement, further complicating migration governance. For example, in early 2023, the region experienced a prolonged drought (the worst in over four decades) which resulted in over 2 million people being internally displaced within Ethiopia and Somalia.⁴

Recognizing these challenges, regional cooperation frameworks have been established to facilitate more effective migration management. The **Khartoum Process**, launched in 2014, serves as a key platform for political dialogue and collaboration between countries along migration routes from the Horn of Africa to Europe. It aims to enhance cooperation on migration and mobility, implement projects targeting human trafficking and smuggling, and strengthen regional partnerships between countries of origin, transit, and destination. Since its inception, the Khartoum Process has underpinned several initiatives, including the BMM programme, which has contributed to improved migration governance, border management, and protection mechanisms across the region. Despite these efforts, continued political commitment and sustained regional cooperation remain crucial to addressing the root causes of migration and ensuring safer, more orderly, and regular migration pathways.

² https://international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu/policies/programming/projects/promoting-safe-and-regular-migration-horn-africa_en

³ <https://documents.worldbank.org/en/publication/documents-reports/documentdetail/837351468189856365/eastern-africa-forced-displacement-and-mixed-migration-in-the-horn-of-africa>

⁴ McAuliffe, M. and L.A. Oucho (eds.), 2024. World Migration Report 2024. International Organization for Migration (IOM), Geneva.

1.2 BETTER MIGRATION MANAGEMENT (BMM) PROGRAMME

1.2.1 Design of the BMM programme

In 2016, the German Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development and the European Union, specifically the EU's Trust Fund for Africa (EUTF)⁵, jointly established the Better Migration Management (BMM) Programme to respond to the needs identified by the African member states of the Khartoum Process. The **overall objective of BMM** was to “*Enable national authorities and institutions to facilitate safe, orderly, and regular migration, and effectively address and reduce trafficking in human beings and the smuggling of migrants within and from the Horn of Africa region by applying a human rights-based approach.*”⁶

The programme had **three components** to achieve its objective:

1. Migration governance to establish a political basis for regionally harmonized migration management
2. Effective institutions to address and reduce trafficking in human beings and the smuggling of migrants
3. Protection of victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants.

In 2022, BMM III was launched and the programme is implemented by **five partner organisations**: the International Organization for Migration (IOM), the British Council, CIVIPOL⁷, the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) and the Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ). GIZ is furthermore the lead implementing partner, and IOM's direct funder. The main **stakeholders** of the programme are government authorities which includes law enforcement, border officials, judiciary, women/social affairs, counter trafficking in persons and national coordination for migration mechanisms; civil society (primarily protection actors); Victims of Trafficking (VoTs) and vulnerable migrants; and communities which are migrant hot spots.⁸

Between 2016 and 2022, BMM's Phase I and Phase II were implemented in Djibouti, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Kenya, Somalia, South Sudan, Sudan, and Uganda. Alignment with existing mechanisms and initiatives of the African Union Commission and the Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD) was key to the programme.⁹

1.2.2 Design and objectives of the BMM Phase III

The **third phase of the BMM** continued activities under the same objective and three components of implementation as the previous phases. BMM newsletters emphasize, however, that Phase III has also focused on how to make the impact of the overall BMM programme **sustainable**: “*The third phase will build on the previous ones and focuses on consolidating a holistic regional approach to migration management and ensuring its sustainability after the programme has ended.*”¹⁰

⁵ The EUTF ended its BMM funding after the Phase II; the EU's funding for the BMM Phase III comes from the “Global Europe: Neighbourhood, Development and International Cooperation Instrument”, NDICI.

⁶ <https://www.giz.de/en/downloads/giz-2023-en-BMM-booklet-2016-2022.pdf>

⁷ CIVIPOL is a technical cooperation operator of the French Ministry of the Interior.

⁸ Information obtained from IOM https://trust-fund-for-africa.europa.eu/document/download/d661333d-6869-45a7-9901-7942e97b75a8_en?filename=t05-eutf-hoa-reg-09 - better migration management incl. 2 addenda.pdf

⁹ https://www.giz.de/en/downloads/2017giz_en_Newsletter_Better_Migration_Management.pdf

¹⁰ <https://www.giz.de/en/downloads/giz2022-en-bmm-newsletter-september.pdf>

Compared to the previous phases, the country scope of Phase III excluded Sudan (except for regional events) and Eritrea, following instructions from GIZ. Phase III has an **overall budget** of EUR 41 million for all implementing partners.¹¹

Phase III of BMM for IOM commenced on 1 October 2022 and ends on 31 March 2025 (with the majority of activities ended in December 2024). IOM's work covered **Djibouti, Ethiopia, Kenya, Somalia, South Sudan, and Uganda**, including joint efforts through regional activities that foster cross-country collaboration and coherence across the participating countries.

As per the previous phases, the contract with the donor was signed by GIZ as the lead implementing partner of the BMM. This contract comprises the overall results framework for the whole BMM Phase III. Subsequently, GIZ and IOM agreed on the results framework and indicators applicable to the IOM component of the BMM.¹² The **budget for IOM's work under Phase III** was set for 9,855,083.66 EUR. IOM submits its annual reports to GIZ, who subsequently reports to the donor.¹³

The original budget was 9,555,083.56 EUR. IOM received a top up signed in early 2024 providing an additional 300,000 EUR for IOM's response to Gender-Based Violence and the Sudan crisis. The additional funds went to the Regional Office for: training on Gender-Based Violence (GBV), development of GBV materials, development of the National Referral Mechanism (NRM) (for Djibouti); and to South Sudan to conduct a GBV mapping at the Sudan/South Sudan border and training for frontline protection actors

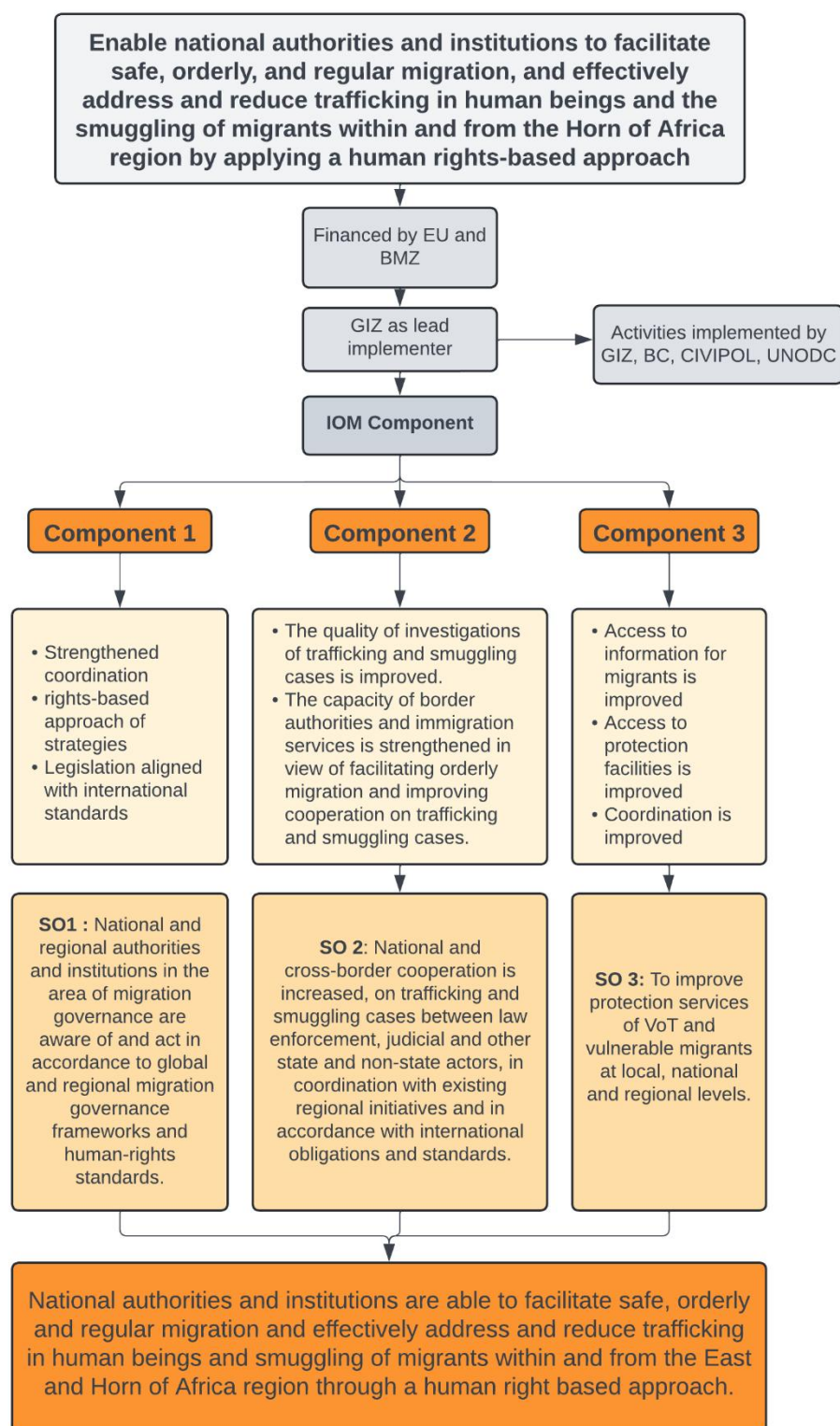
The BMM Programme has a set list of objectives, outcomes and outputs which are drafted for all implementing partners, which forms IOM's results matrix. The following figure demonstrates the **Intervention Logic** of IOM's activities under BMM Phase III.

¹¹ <https://www.giz.de/en/downloads/giz-2024-en-BMM-newsletter-no-15.pdf>

¹² Inception workshop.

¹³ Annual Report 1 October 2023 to 30 September 2024.

Figure 1. Intervention Logic of BMM Phase III (reconstructed based on internal IOM documentation)



1.3 EVALUATION BACKGROUND

This **evaluation** focuses on IOM activities within the BMM Phase III and does not include an evaluation of the work of other BMM partners on their components. It is a *final* evaluation with the objective of examining and reviewing the results achieved by IOM's BMM interventions.¹⁴ It is also an *external* evaluation considering that two external consultants were recruited to conduct the evaluation.

The evaluation was conducted for use by the IOM BMM project management team to **assess the results of IOM activities within the BMM Phase III, document key lessons learned and best practices** from a complete set of activities and **provide recommendations** to inform the development of a fourth phase of BMM. The evaluation examines the success of implementation across each of the above-mentioned three components.

In addition, the evaluation considered BMM specific **cross-cutting themes** and their integration in the programme design, implementation, and reporting. These themes are gender, human rights, peace and security, participatory development and good governance, poverty orientation and migration and climate change.

This evaluation covers **the entire implementation period of the BMM programme's third phase** (1 October 2022 to 31 March 2025, all six countries, and all its stages, including programme conceptualization, stakeholders' engagement, implementation of the activities, and project reporting. The evaluation does not cover the first phase and second phases of the BMM, which were between April 2016 and October 2022.

The **intended audience** of the evaluation includes IOM, government authorities which acted as counterparts of the Programme, the civil society organizations (CSOs) involved in implementing the programme and beneficiaries, including local government authorities and other stakeholders.

¹⁴ A final, or terminal, evaluation is undertaken at the end, or close to the end, of an intervention to examine the overall performance and achievement of results, also for the benefit of stakeholders not directly involved in the management and implementation of the intervention (such as donors and governmental entities) (IOM Monitoring and Evaluation Guidelines).

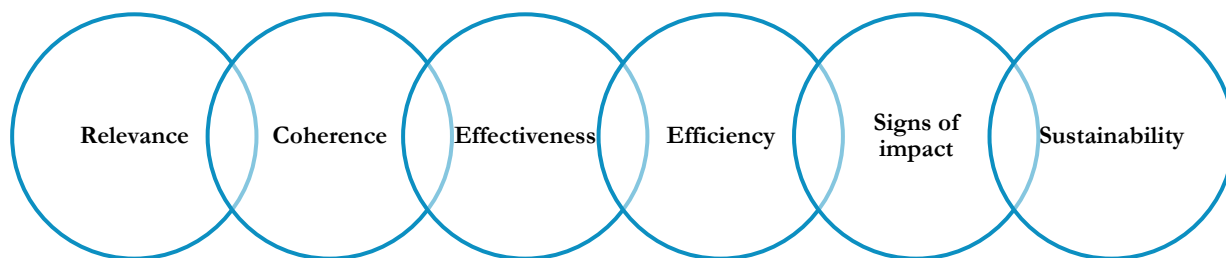
2. EVALUATION APPROACH AND METHODOLOGY

2.1. EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

The evaluation used a **theory-based approach**, utilizing the intervention logic presented above to understand whether the implemented activities have indeed contributed to the envisaged outputs, outcomes, and impact. The **Evaluation Matrix** was developed based on the Organisation of Economic Cooperation and Development/Development Assistance Committee (OECD/DAC) evaluation criteria and quality standards. Besides the six criteria, the evaluation reviewed the cross-cutting issues of gender, human rights, peace and security, participatory development and good governance, poverty orientation and migration and climate change.

The evaluation matrix was updated from the Terms of Reference and based on initial conversations with IOM on the needs for the evaluation – and therefore the priorities for specific questions and criteria. Namely, the evaluation timeframe does not allow for comprehensive coverage of each question. The final report will cover all six evaluation criteria (Figure 2), but it will **prioritise effectiveness, efficiency and sustainability**, as agreed with IOM in the Inception Stage.

Figure 2. OECD/DAC criteria for evaluations



Each evaluation question includes the main data collection methods that will be used to collect information to answer the question, as well as key indicators that measure trends or the state of play/level regarding the change or situation the evaluation question refers to.

The main evaluation questions from the Terms of Reference (attached in Annex 1), are presented below, while the full evaluation matrix is added in Annex 2.

Relevance:

- Were IOM's interventions aligned with national and regional priorities, strategies and policies?
- Was the project relevant to the needs of beneficiaries and target groups? To what extent were those needs taken into account during project design?
- Did IOM's activities remain valid and pertinent as originally planned, or were they subsequently modified? (If modified, analysis on component with most modifications, reasons, and overview of bottlenecks)
- How did project stakeholders, including partners, beneficiaries, and duty-bearers, show their participation and ownership? More precisely, in what ways did they contribute to IOM's project design and implementation via collaboration, coordination, or providing support?

Coherence:

- How well does the project align and is compatible with other IOM projects or activities? Have any complementarities or synergies been observed?
- To what extent do IOM's interventions under BMM align and are compatible with activities implemented through other BMM implementing organisations? Have any complementarities or synergies been observed and where are there areas of opportunity?

Effectiveness:

- Have the project's outputs and outcomes been achieved in accordance with the stated Activity Work Plans and results matrix?
- Was the quality of project outputs deemed satisfactory by the main stakeholders?
- What major internal and external factors have influenced (positively or negatively) the effective achievement of project's outcomes?
- To what extent has the project adapted to changing external conditions in order to ensure project outcomes?

Efficiency:

- How efficient was the overall management and implementation of the project? Were there any significant delays in the overall implementation?
- How cost-effective was the project? Were the incurred costs proportional to the results achieved? Could the activities have been executed with fewer resources without compromising the quality and quantity of the results?
- Were the project monitoring and reporting (technical and financial) procedures well-established at country level, and conducive to tracking implementation progress in a timely manner, to share with the Regional Office?

Impact:

- What are the most significant changes or impacts, whether positive, negative, intended, or unintended, that have emerged in the short or medium term as a result of the project?
- Did the intervention take timely measures for mitigating any unplanned negative impacts?

Sustainability:

- Did the project take specific measures to guarantee sustainability as per the matrix developed and how was this supported by partners and the IOM?
- Did the target groups/stakeholders make any plans to continue with ensuring the project deliverables persisted after the end of BMM's support?

2.2. DATA COLLECTION

The evaluation largely relied on desk research (secondary data) and primary data collected through interventions with relevant IOM staff and BMM implementing partners and stakeholders. Quantitative data was collected from IOM (statistical programme data).

2.2.1. Desk research

The first step of data collection was **desk research**, which included a review of all available programme documentation. IOM provided the evaluation team with all relevant documentation and information. Additionally, the team has collected background documentation on migration trends, flows, and statistics in the region, and the main challenges faced by migrants, returnees, and communities.

Desk research was implemented in two phases:

- **Initial desk research** was carried out in the inception phase to help the evaluation team better understand the initiative. Desk research was used to re-create the Intervention Logic and prepare a preliminary list of interviewees for the data collection stage.
- **Desk research for data collection and analysis** was carried out after the approval of the Inception Report. During this phase, the evaluation team focused on the specific questions set out in the evaluation grid and focus on the triangulation of the primary data sources.

2.2.2. Interviews

The interview programme comprised the largest data collection effort of the evaluation. The evaluation team identified several groups of interview respondents to be included in the evaluation, based on a purposive sampling approach. Namely, the evaluators spoke with the stakeholders who were most engaged in the programme and who could therefore provide the most detailed feedback on its achievements. As limitation, this left out the opinions of less engaged stakeholders and opportunity to explore why they were less engaged.

The evaluators conducted **40 interviews with IOM staff, government stakeholders and CSOs** who participated in the implementation of the programme, at both national and regional levels, in BMM implementing countries. All countries (Djibouti, Kenya, Somalia, South Sudan, Ethiopia and Uganda) and stakeholder groups were covered. Interviews also covered all other partner organisations implementing BMM, i.e., GIZ, CIVIPOL, British Council and UNODC. The following table includes the number of interviewed respondents per organization and country, while the full list of respondents is added in Annex 3:

IOM and other implementing partners (30)	National government and CSO stakeholders (10)
- Regional IOM staff (11) - Country Office IOM staff (12) - GIZ (2) - CIVIPOL (1) - British Council (2) - UNODC (2)	Government and/or CSO officials: - Djibouti (1) - Ethiopia (1) - Kenya (2) - Somalia (3) - Uganda (1) - South Sudan (2)

2.3. DATA ANALYSIS AND LIMITATIONS

Qualitative data was collected from desk research, and interviews. Interviews were summarised in writing and anonymised. **Quantitative information** was collected through desk research (programme statistical data). All data collected was **triangulated**, meaning that data from different sources was analysed together and used to answer an evaluation question. This ensured enhance validity and reliability of the findings as the findings from one data source were tested and validated using data from other sources.

The analysis relied on **contribution analysis**, as the evaluators aimed to establish links between the activities and inputs of IOM and BMM to the measured outcomes, while subsequently identifying other factors/actors that may have influenced the achievement of outcomes.

While the evaluators have taken all possible steps to ensure the quality of the report and its content, the evaluation faced some **limitations**. Time and resource limits did not allow for field visits to the six countries, nor for interviews with beneficiary migrants themselves. This was mitigated through online interviews with national government respondents from all BMM participant countries, who were asked about the programme's relevance, effectiveness and impact for migrants.

3. EVALUATION FINDINGS

3.1. RELEVANCE

The criterion of relevance reviews the IOM objectives and activities under BMM Phase III in relation to the main needs and priorities of beneficiaries and stakeholders in the region and partner countries. Additionally, the criterion assesses whether the programme remained relevant in changing circumstances at national or regional level.

3.1.1. Alignment with regional and national needs

IOM's activities under BMM Phase III were well-aligned with the migration challenges and priorities of the region, demonstrating strong relevance at both national and regional levels.

Migration within the East and Horn of Africa region, and from the region towards the Middle East and Europe, is highly risky, particularly for refugees, displaced populations, and irregular migrants. The migration flow along the Eastern Route to the Arabian Peninsula has traditionally been one of the world's busiest and continuously growing maritime migration routes. This route sees both outward migration and return movements, including voluntary and forced returns. Against this backdrop, the shared migration issues have to be addressed through a **cross-country, regional approach** as “tackling this problem only at a national level would simply risk displacing the existing smuggling/trafficking route”.¹⁵ Interviewed IOM staff confirmed that, while countries have their own unique contexts, they face similar challenges related to migration, warranting a joint and coordinated regional response.¹⁶

Migration governance in the region is affected by weak institutions, inconsistent legal and policy frameworks across the region, and high levels of corruption which all hinder effective national and cross-border cooperation on trafficking and irregular migration.¹⁷ A needs assessment conducted for the design of the EUTF in 2015 found that countries part of the Khartoum Process share the need for increased capacity (e.g. related to border management and data collection), increased awareness among the general population, and protection of migrants.¹⁸ Interviewees mentioned various challenges faced by migrants in the region, ranging from the consequences of trafficking and smuggling to the absence of awareness of human rights among migrants. For example, interviewed IOM staff noted the complicated nature of **protection of victims**: “hotels are not always safe enough for migrants fleeing from organised crime. We need safe houses”.¹⁹ Children form a particularly vulnerable group and are also prone to fall victim to recruitment by trafficking and smuggling rings.²⁰

Against this backdrop, the BMM programme and related IOM activities, focused on strengthening migration governance, border management, and migrant protection. They directly **addressed the priorities identified by national governments and regional bodies**. As an IOM staff member noted, “BMM addressed the

¹⁵ The European Union Emergency Trust Fund for Stability and Addressing the Root Causes of Irregular Migration and Displaced Persons in Africa: Action Fiche for the implementation of the Horn of Africa Window. 2018.

¹⁶ Interviews with IOM staff.

¹⁷ James Owino (2021) Durable solutions to migration challenges in East Africa and the Horn.

¹⁸ The European Union Emergency Trust Fund for Stability and Addressing the Root Causes of Irregular Migration and Displaced Persons in Africa: Action Fiche for the implementation of the Horn of Africa Window. 2018.

¹⁹ Interview with IOM staff.

²⁰ Interview with IOM staff.

general absence of active partners who are supporting the government in the migration sector, by bringing the topic forward as an area of concern and supporting their responsibilities under the Global Compact for Migration.”

All interviewed national government officials confirmed the **importance of IOM’s activities in shaping migration policies and strengthening institutions**. In Somalia, for example, IOM supported the development of required regulations to implement the revised Immigration Act passed in March 2023. As one national government representative stated, “IOM is the one who has been really supporting all along from its inception to when [the Act] was signed and approved under the BMM.” Similarly, another national stakeholder confirmed that the programme was well aligned with national priorities, particularly in migration governance and counter-trafficking: “The program was designed and focused on regional collaboration but aligned also with national priorities.” **Awareness-raising efforts** were also a key aspect of the programme’s relevance. One national stakeholder highlighted the importance of community engagement: “The support in terms of creating awareness to the local leadership and local communities on migration along these routes, to me, that is a priority.”

IOM activities were also crucial in **facilitating regional cooperation**. By addressing inconsistencies in migration policies and border management, as well as lack of cross-border cooperation, it enabled more coordinated responses to transnational challenges. As one stakeholder noted, “The BMM project was instrumental in bringing the governments in this region together so that they can actually informally have a dialogue on issues of migration governance.” IOM activities also helped to mobilise other actors in the migration sector, especially through actions under SO2 focused on the training of law enforcement officials and border authorities, and the creation or strengthening of cross-border coordination bodies.

3.1.2. Ability to respond to changing contexts

The programme’s and IOM flexibility allowed it to adapt to shifting political and security dynamics, ensuring continued relevance throughout its implementation. However, challenges such as limited resources for protection and reliance on external funding remain areas requiring attention in future phases.

The dynamic nature of migration trends and political shifts in the region required the programme to be adaptable. **Country office IOM teams** worked closely with governments to ensure relevance, adjusting activities based on emerging needs. An IOM staff member explained: “Thanks to the flexibility and the regular discussions on the work plan, we were able to make sure that BMM was relevant throughout Phase III.” A key role in this regard was played by the **IOM Regional Office** which ensured adaptive management of the overall IOM activities under BMM Phase III and responded to various internal and external inquiries in a swift manner.

Examples of situations affecting the programme’s relevance included changing government priorities and security situations.²¹ For instance, the outbreak of the conflict in Sudan had profound impact on the implementation of BMM Phase III in **South Sudan**, as South Sudan received an increased number of returning South Sudanese nationals, Sudanese refugees, and third country nationals fleeing Sudan. For the first month of Phase III, all efforts of BMM were geared towards assessing and building capacity of border control officials,

²¹ See Section 3.3.4 for a detailed analysis of factors which affected implementation.

assessing the needs of different types of migrants, and support reception areas for migrants.²² Accordingly, BMM Phase III redirected its focus to strengthening border control and migrant reception capacities as well as the capacity of frontline protection actors to identify and support victims of gender-based violence. Similarly, **Somalia's** accession to the East African Community (EAC) accelerated the need for harmonized border management, prompting the programme to fast-track the establishment of Integrated border management committees.

The programme also demonstrated responsiveness to government requests. One IOM interviewee in **Djibouti** described a case in which a national government shifted priorities midway through the programme: “We agreed to provide support to the expansion of the MIDAS. However, in the middle of the project, the government decided that they did not want this system anymore. We reallocated the budget for MIDAS to support the government with their e-visa system instead.” Another example of adaptive management practices was given by IOM country office staff in **Kenya**: “Thanks to the flexibility and the regular discussions on the work plan, we were able to make sure that BMM was relevant throughout Phase III. There was a request from the Government for consultations on an integrated border management policy. This was not something that was part of BMM from the beginning, but we were able to move resources around to respond to the request.”

National contexts evolved differently during the implementation of Phase III, with different effects on the implementation of the programme. Interviewed IOM staff confirmed that they aimed to adjust to unforeseen circumstances or changing contexts as much as possible within the BMM framework. This flexibility was enabled by the design of the overall BMM programme, which allowed **country office IOM staff to agree with national stakeholders on priorities and objectives for the national level**, instead of “imposing a set of activities”. This ensured that the regional BMM Theory of Change was relevant for each country and aligned with (changing) priorities.²³

3.2. COHERENCE

The coherence of IOM's activities under BMM Phase III is assessed in relation to their alignment with other IOM initiatives in the region, as well as with the work of other implementing partners. This analysis considers both internal coordination within IOM and external coherence with national governments, regional bodies, and other international organizations.

3.2.1. Internal alignment with other efforts of IOM

IOM activities under BMM Phase III demonstrated strong internal coherence by leveraging synergies with other IOM projects, enabling cost-sharing and expanding programme reach.

The number of ongoing IOM projects and initiatives differed across the six programme countries. A key strategy for internal coherence was the **co-funding** and **joint implementation** of activities, allowing for more comprehensive migration governance interventions. In many cases, such synergies focused on joint activities and cost-sharing (as mentioned under efficiency) but also on expanding the scope of activities to more geographical areas of the country.

²² Interview with IOM staff

²³ Interviews with IOM staff

The following statements by IOM staff interviewees in Kenya illustrate IOM efforts to ensure internal coherence:

“We were planning to conduct an assessment on border management and management of mixed migration flows. Under BMM, we would be able to focus on one border. However, we had some resources under another project which we could use to expand the assessment to all borders.”

“The BMM project was able to support the implementation of the NCM [National Coordination Mechanism]. However, through the support of another project, we were also able to establish sub-national NCMs in major cities. This allowed us to get the full picture on migration governance and its indicators, from the grassroot to the to the national level.”

This strategic alignment allowed IOM to optimize resources and avoid duplication of efforts, ensuring a broader and more impactful reach. One of the key **enabling factors** to ensure internal coherence mentioned by the interview partners was the **IOM Regional Office's active role** in maintaining a broader perspective and ensuring cross-country synergies an coordination and alignment to regional frameworks. For instance, the Regional Office made sure that IOM activities under BMM at the same time contribute to the Regional Migrant Response Plan coordinated by the IOM. Overall, no significant overlaps or duplications between IOM activities under BMM programme and other IOM initiatives were flagged to the evaluation team by the interviewees.

3.2.2. External alignment with efforts and organizations outside IOM

IOM's activities under BMM Phase III also demonstrated strong external coherence, successfully aligning with regional migration frameworks, national policies, and international donor-funded initiatives. IOM worked alongside BMM implementing partners UNODC, GIZ, CIVIPOL, and the British Council. However, while some collaborations were well-integrated, others remained limited, with partners working in silos rather than through a fully coordinated approach.

BMM Phase III demonstrated strong coherence with other international and national migration-related programmes, often integrating activities with those of the European Union, bilateral donors, and regional organizations. This was particularly evident in areas such as migrant protection, governance, and border management. For example, in Djibouti, through BMM, IOM partnered with the Djibouti Red Crescent to provide direct assistance for transitory and stranded migrants. In Uganda, BMM and the Swiss-funded Spotlight Initiative collaborated on addressing gender-based violence in migration contexts.

Additionally, BMM Phase III **aligned with regional frameworks** such as IGAD Regional Migration Policy Framework, promoting cross-border cooperation and policy harmonization. This regional approach was critical, as tackling migration challenges at a national level alone risked shifting smuggling and trafficking routes rather than addressing root causes. A stakeholder emphasized this point: “The BMM project was instrumental in bringing the governments in this region together so that they can actually informally have a dialogue on issues of migration governance.”

In **terms of alignment between IOM and other BMM implementing partners**, interview partners noted that the design of the BMM programme did not require partners to necessarily work together – “there was division of labour which ensured that each organization focuses on its areas of expertise”. Nevertheless, some joint initiatives and synergies between partners’ activities were mentioned. Most examples of synergies created between IOM’s BMM component and the work of the other BMM partners were mentioned in relation to

UNODC (in the field of counter trafficking) and GIZ, and more sporadically with CIVIPOL. Various examples were provided of joint activities or joint development of deliverables. For instance, country office IOM staff in Djibouti explained that “IOM has shared activities with GIZ where we [IOM] developed a budgeted roadmap for the implementation of the National Migration Strategy and GIZ has developed a monitoring and evaluation system to evaluate and to coordinate activities related to the roadmap.” Fewer examples were provided of synergies or shared activities with the British Council. The interview quotes below offer further examples of how activities were shared or differentiated between implementing partners and IOM:

“GIZ was able to establish local task forces in different districts. Therefore, when we went to the field, we could work with those focal persons that GIZ identified within the field to disseminate our message and for the messages and to be cascaded further. We also worked with GIZ on the development of the communication strategy and specific messages.”²⁴

“UNODC developed a curriculum in terms of trafficking in person for the National School of the Judiciary System, and from our part, we conducted a training for national stakeholders on the protection and identification of referral of victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants. So UNODC was more focused on the persecution and judicial part, and we have mainly focused on the protection side.”²⁵

Nevertheless, the **dual role of GIZ** as both a “grant giver” and an implementer added complexity and occasionally created uncertainty among IOM regarding the division of labour or lines of communication. However, active engagement and cooperative relationship between the GIZ and IOM Regional Office helped to mitigate potential tensions and avoid overlaps.

Overall, IOM demonstrated strong internal and external coherence, with well-integrated activities across IOM programmes and effective collaboration with national and international partners. Joint implementation, cost-sharing, and alignment with regional migration frameworks enhanced the achievements of the programme.

3.3. EFFECTIVENESS

Effectiveness measures the achievements and progress made by IOM during the BMM Phase III, within each of the three dimensions as presented in the intervention logic.

3.3.1. Specific Objective 1: National and regional authorities in the field of migration governance are aware of, and act in accordance with, international and regional frameworks for migration governance and human rights standards.

Specific Objective 1 of the BMM programme aims to enhance migration governance in the EHoA by aligning national and regional authorities with global and regional migration governance frameworks and human rights standards. This is to be achieved through a multi-faceted approach across the region and participating countries, encompassing building evidence bases for to support policy development, enhancing coordination between stakeholders through meetings, workshops and events, and conducting training and capacity building on key migration governance related concepts.

²⁴ Interview with IOM staff

²⁵ Interview with IOM staff

The evaluation found that IOM has made substantial progress in improving migration governance frameworks in the EHoA region. The programme successfully engaged with national and regional authorities to harmonize migration policies with international standards and strengthen institutional capacities.

At the **regional level**, IOM supported **policy and coordination mechanisms**. In September 2023, BMM countries and an East African Community (EAC) representative attended a workshop in Entebbe on mixed migration flows and the migration-environment-climate nexus. In November 2024, IOM supported the first EAC Regional Consultative Process (RCP) on Migration, bringing together various EAC member states²⁶. A key outcome was the creation of the EAC RCP's Action Plan on Migration. In July 2023, IOM held a virtual meeting to introduce a report on the mapping of migration policies in the EHoA produced under BMM III, with the African Union Commission, IGAD, and EAC. This helped stakeholders understand regional migration policy advancements. In May 2024, IOM hosted a workshop on Digital Legal Identity for 31 government officials from nine African countries. The workshop covered digital ID systems, data protection, and legal frameworks, aligning with Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) 16.9 and 17.19.2, contributing to the Common and Free Movement Protocols of the EAC and IGAD.

At the **country level**, the evaluation found evidence for IOM activities contributing to the achievement of BMM's Specific Objective 1. Some of these activities, as documented in IOM annual reports, include:

- In **Djibouti**, IOM partnered with the National Coordination office for Migration in Djibouti (BCNM) Office to conduct workshops presenting the national migration strategy and its five-year action plan. Additionally, IOM supported the finalization of a budgeted roadmap for the National Migration Strategy and its five-year action plan through consultations. Capacity-building for the BCNM included office equipment and training on migration governance, the Global Compact for Migration (GCM), and SDGs. IOM supported Institut National de la Statistique et de la Démographie to conduct its population census, develop a report on migrant information from the census, and to develop a National Statistical Yearbook on Migration and Displacement. Furthermore, in May 2024, a study tour to Tanzania provided Djiboutian stakeholders insights into border management and interagency cooperation. In July 2024, IOM trained participants on labor migration governance and bilateral agreements.
- In **Ethiopia**, IOM initiated the second phase of the Organizational Capacity Assessment (OCA) to assist National and Regional Partnership Coalitions (NPC and RPC) in evaluating their strengths and challenges, which was compiled into an Organisational Development Plan with corresponding capacity building initiatives. IOM facilitated the NPC's biannual review meeting and participated in multiple strategic planning discussions, including the implementation of the five-year Strategic Plan and migration reviews at national and regional levels. Moreover, IOM continued advocacy efforts for the endorsement of Ethiopia's National Migration Policy, alongside support for key review workshops, including the Oromia RPC annual review and Dire Dawa RPC Secretariat's planning sessions. Additionally, Capacity-building activities included the Essentials of Migration Management training, an M&E workshop, and an OCA presentation on the NPC and RCP results.

²⁶ Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, South Sudan, Rwanda, Burundi, the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC), and Somalia.

- In **Kenya**, IOM facilitated multiple consultative forums for the NCM to advance the National Migration Policy (NMP) and the National Implementation Plan for the Global Compact for Migration, while also addressing cross-border issues through the development of a first draft of an Integrated Border Management (IBM) policy. Additionally, IOM rolled out a Community of Practice (COP) in counties like Nairobi, Mombasa, Lamu, and Kisumu to tackle trafficking, migrant protection, and policy harmonization. Organizational workshops and meetings were held to enhance migration governance, culminating in the revision of Kenya's Migration Profile and the development of the National Migration Coordination Directorate.
- In **Somalia**, IOM assisted the Federal Government in developing a second draft of the NMP, integrating feedback from various stakeholders and ensuring alignment with global migration governance frameworks. IOM also supported the Immigration and Citizenship Agency (ICA) in developing regulations for the Immigration Act and the ICA Establishment Law. As one national official put it, “Without IOM, this thing [the regulations] would not have a life and would not even exist.” Additionally, IOM organized training sessions for ICA officials to improve understanding and operationalize the IBM Committees (IBMCs).
- In **South Sudan**, IOM organized meetings for government officials to strengthen migration governance aspects and supported the ratification of international conventions to combat trafficking in persons and smuggling of migrants. For instance, IOM supported two Inter-Ministerial Summits on Migration Governance in South Sudan during November 2023 and December 2024 following a NCM meeting. IOM also initiated the procurement of server room and networking equipment for launch of a migration database housed under the National Bureau of Statistics and handed over a vehicle to support its work. Additionally IOM conducted training for immigration officers to support the implementation of a National Border Strategy developed through BMM II.
- In **Uganda**, IOM supported the finalization of the draft National Migration Policy, contributed to workshops to review and validate it, and initiated discussions regarding the NMP roadmap and harmonization with other national policies. Additionally, IOM supported the Ministry of Internal Affairs with developing and launching a National Trafficking in Persons (TiP) database at the central level. IOM organized community-based dialogues to raise awareness about TiP and protect vulnerable children. Furthermore, IOM supported government officials in the October 2024 Africa Regional Review of the GCM, contributing to Uganda's migration governance efforts. A consultant was onboarded to lead the development of Uganda's GCM National Action Plan. Since December 2023, IOM has strengthened NCM support through staff secondments, quarterly meetings, training sessions, and a Training Package. Finally, IOM conducted a handover session to the Ministry of Gender Labour and Social Development of two pivotal publications drafted under BMM II (the Pre-departure Orientation Curriculum and the Migrants' Handbook).

Overall, IOM has successfully met the absolute majority of its indicators under Specific Objective 1, with several being exceeded by the time of this evaluation (see Table 1 below).

Table 1: Achievement of activities under Specific Objective 1 (based on IOM documentation and as of March 18, 2025).

Specific Objective 1			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
SOI 1.1	Number of relevant regional policy fora referencing lessons learned, cooperation challenges	2 relevant regional policy fora	Fully

	and recommendations drawn from the implementation of BMM III		
SOI 1.2	Number of mandated national migration coordination bodies supported in their progress monitoring and reporting concerning regional migration strategies and plans	3 national migration coordination bodies supported	Fully
SOI 1.3	Number of newly developed or revised national migration policies, strategies and legal frameworks, which are in accordance with regional frameworks and international law	5 newly developed or revised national migration policies, strategies and legal frameworks	Exceeded 9 newly developed or revised national migration policies, strategies and legal frameworks
Output 1.1 Coordination between government institutions responsible for migration management at local, national and regional levels is strengthened, effective and coherent.			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 1.1.1	Number of documents (working plans, protocols, strategies) confirming the enhanced cooperation within and between national and sub-national migration management coordination mechanisms in line with a whole-of-government approach have been implemented	5 documents confirming enhanced cooperation	Exceeded 8 documents confirming enhanced cooperation
OI 1.1.2	Number of migrations affected communities formulate recommendations regarding their needs and priorities concerning migration for y number of decision-making processes	5 communities in 1 country 4 decision making processes	Fully ²⁷ 4 communities in Kenya participated in 4 decision-making processes
Output 1.2 The rights-based approach of the (further) development and/ or implementation of national and regional policies and strategies on safe and regular migration is supported.			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value

²⁷ Evaluation team notes that the target value for set for both IOM and GIZ. Provided documentation shows that IOM implemented country outreach programmes in 4 counties (Kiambu, Mombasa, Lamu, and Nairobi), while GIZ in Kisumu. On this basis, the attained value for the IOM is assessed as 'fully'.

OI 1.2.1	Number of regional, bilateral or multi-country policies, guidelines and/or strategies related to safe, orderly and regular migration (including consultative and validation processes), developed, revised or/ and implemented revised with support of BMM III (EURF 2.21)	1 regional or multi-country policies/guidelines, strategies	Exceeded Contribution to 2 policies in the region
OI 1.2.2	Number of reports relevant to policy making using (digital) gender-sensitive migration data from mandated institutions supported in BMM III.	3 reports relevant to policy making using gender sensitive migration data from mandated institutions	Partially 2 reports ²⁸
OI 1.2.3	Number of national policies and/ or strategies on regular and safe migration (including consultative and validation processes), or their revision aligned to regional policy framework, taking special account of human rights and gender equality principles (further) developed and/ or implemented with support of BMM III.	2 national policies and/or strategies in at least 3 countries	Exceeded 4 policies supported
Output 1.3: National legislation in target countries on trafficking in human beings and smuggling of migrants and related issues are drafted or revised in accordance with international conventions and standards			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 1.3.1	Number of national legislation or secondary legislation on countering TiP and SoM, (further) developed with support of BMM III and being in line with international Conventions.	3 legislations supported in at least 2 countries	Fully²⁹ 2 national legislations or secondary legislations on countering TiP and SoM

²⁸ However, two additional reports (from South Sudan and Uganda) are planned to be delivered by the end of March 2025.

²⁹ Although the target value refers to 3 legislations, actions on one of the planned legislations (in Uganda) were already finalized under BMM Phase II. Thus, after consultations with IOM, evaluation team assessed the attained value as 'fully'.

3.3.2. Specific Objective 2: The quality of national and cross-border cooperation on trafficking and smuggling cases between law enforcement, judicial and other state and nonstate actors, in coordination with existing regional initiatives and in accordance with international obligations and standards, is increased

Specific Objective 2 of the BMM programme aims to increase the quality of national and cross-border cooperation on trafficking and smuggling cases. This objective is to be achieved by aligning efforts with existing regional initiatives and adhering to international obligations and standards. The approach includes strengthening the capacity of state institutions, enhancing coordination between stakeholders through meetings, workshops, and events, and conducting training and capacity-building activities focused on key aspects of cross-border cooperation.

The evaluation found that IOM has enhanced national and cross-border cooperation on human trafficking and smuggling cases by supporting law enforcement agencies, judicial institutions, and civil society actors.

At the **regional level**, IOM achieved significant milestones by conducting two training sessions for frontline border officials and government officials in May and September 2023 on the operationalization of One Stop Border Posts (OSBPs), in collaboration with IOM's African Capacity Building Centre in Tanzania. These sessions utilized the newly published IBM Training Manual. Additionally, the IBM training manual was revised in French to be better utilized in Djibouti. In November 2023, IOM facilitated a regional IBM Training of Trainers (ToT) for border officials from Djibouti, Ethiopia, Kenya, Somalia, South Sudan, and Uganda, focusing on gender, human rights, and participatory development. This training led to improved understanding and capabilities in IBM principles, particularly in border operations and government authority identification. Additionally, in April 2024, IOM held a regional training on OSBP operations for participants from EAC and IGAD member states, covering topics such as balancing migration and human rights, trade facilitation, and ensuring gender mainstreaming and inclusion in border management.

At the **country level**, the evaluation found evidence of IOM activities contributing to the achievement of BMM's Specific Objective 2. These activities, as documented in IOM annual reports, include:

- In **Djibouti**, IOM assessed the Djibouti coastguard's equipment needs to enhance their response to migration-related challenges, including search and rescue operations. Following this assessment, IOM has provided essential search and rescue equipment materials to the Djibouti Coast Guard and Djiboutian Police, to support cross border management and migrant protection operations. Additionally, IOM and GIZ collaborated with Djibouti's Ministry of Interior and the Directorate General of the National Police to improve immigration services by providing equipment for processing E-Visa requests. This support followed a border post evaluation that identified infrastructure needs at key locations such as the Balho and Galilah Border Crossing Points. Finally, IOM supported two government officials to attend training on TiP and prosecution in Spain.
- In **Ethiopia**, IOM facilitated a study tour in Uganda for Ethiopian officials to learn best practices in IBM and address cross-border challenges. To further enhance capacity, IOM conducted two Integrated Border Governance (IBG) training sessions in April and August 2024, equipping 84 border officials with skills in migration management, gender issues, health at borders, and migrant protection. In October 2024, IOM and Immigration and Citizenship Services (ICS) conducted an IBM training for newly recruited ICS officers, reaching a total of 139 participants (112 male and 27 female); and a

MIDAS Training of Trainers took place from December 2-6, with 23 border officials from Bole International Airport. Additionally, IOM, with Swiss government co-funding, installed the MIDAS at Addis Ababa Bole International Airport, processing almost 130,000 visas on arrival since its launch in May 2024. In October 2024, ICS assessed three Border Crossing Points (BCPs) – Galafi, Tog Wajaale, and Kurmuk. Looking ahead, IOM plans to enhance MIDAS by adding a module in conjunction with the Ministry of Women and Social Affairs that supports the identification and referral of vulnerable migrants upon their return.

- In **Kenya**, IOM has strengthened migration management through capacity-building initiatives, policy assessments, and community engagement. IOM sponsored 15 students for a postgraduate diploma in migration management at the Kenya Institute of Migration Studies and supported 19 border officials through a training program. IOM facilitated three mobile registration drives in Kajiado, Kisumu, and Kwale counties, enabling 6,586 individuals to obtain legal documents. In May 2024, IOM trained 22 law enforcement officials in Turkana on migration management and TiP prevention, followed by community workshops reaching 650 participants. IOM also conducted a Humanitarian Border Management assessment in collaboration with the Border Management Secretariat, engaging 117 officials to identify challenges and recommend improvements. IOM also donated communication equipment to Secretariat, co-hosted the first National Border Management Conference, and organized a study visit to the UK for 10 border management officials, providing insights into security risk management and advanced screening techniques.
- In **Somalia**, IOM has enhanced migration management through institutional capacity building, policy implementation support, and cross-border cooperation. IOM facilitated the establishment of five IBMCs to strengthen coordination between Points of Entry and trained new IBMC members in different locations. To combat Trafficking in Persons, IOM trained frontline officers on victim identification, international migration law, and human rights standards. A study tour to Rwanda enabled Somali officials to observe best practices in inter-agency border operations. IOM also supported the rollout of the Immigration Act and ICA Law by training 42 officers from key entry points, including Mogadishu's airport, seaport, and enrolment centres. The training provided practical guidance on implementing new policies. Additionally, IOM facilitated multiple trainings on Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for IBMCs across different regions, reinforcing Somalia's border management framework.
- In **South Sudan**, IOM organized seven trainings for 169 border officials (127 male, 42 female), held in different locations, to strengthen their capacities and align their activities with international best practices. Trainings were organized in cooperation with local institutions such as the Directorate of Nationality, Passports, and Immigration.
- In **Uganda**, IOM conducted several trainings for border officials on border management and migration. For instance, in March 2024 for 37 West Nile border officials and in May 2024 for border officials from Uganda's western regions. These trainings focused on border security, trade facilitation, and migration management to learn best practices for assisting vulnerable migrants.

Overall, from the three indicators under SO2, IOM has exceeded two and fully achieved one (see Table 2 below), showing effectiveness towards achieving increased quality of national and cross-border cooperation on trafficking and smuggling cases.

Table 2: Achievement of activities under Specific Objective 2 (based on IOM documentation and as of March 18, 2025).

Output 2.1 The quality and comprehensiveness of national and regional investigations of trafficking and smuggling cases is improved			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 2.1.4	Percentage of graduates of national police and/ or other law enforcement academies that have been trained with integrated modules on THB and SoM as part of the standard curriculum according to international standard and in alignment with gender-, human-, and child- rights principles.	Contribution to 70% of 2,500 graduates	Fully³⁰ 15 students sponsored
Output 2.3 The capacity of border authorities and immigration services is strengthened in view of facilitating orderly migration and improving cooperation on trafficking and smuggling cases			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 2.3.1	Percentage of trained border / immigration officials confirm enhanced gender and age specific knowledge on the identification and referral of victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants	70% of 300 border officials confirm enhanced knowledge	Exceeded 598 border officials trained ³¹
OI 2.3.2	Number of cross-border coordination bodies, groups and initiatives between relevant state and non-state institutions in cross-border regions supported (including needed equipment) to facilitate safe, orderly and regular migration.	5 cross-border coordination bodies, groups and initiatives in 2 cross-border regions	Exceeded 20 initiatives

3.3.3. Specific Objective 3: Protection services for Victims of Trafficking and of vulnerable migrants are improved at local, national, and regional levels

Specific Objective 3 of the BMM programme aims to improve protection services for VoTs and vulnerable migrants at local, national, and regional levels. This objective is to be achieved by aligning efforts with existing regional initiatives and adhering to international obligations and standards. The approach includes enhancing access to information on safe, orderly, and regular migration, improving access to protection facilities and services, and conducting training and capacity-building activities focused on key aspects of migrant protection.

According to data collected, IOM has contributed to improved access to information and protection facilities and services for migrants.

³⁰ The 2.1.4 target value is the overall target for IOM, UNODC, GIZ, and CIVIPOL without a specific target for IOM only. IOM has been sponsoring 5 students a year (which was coordinated with the GIZ as lead implementer).

³¹ Further trainings conducted under IBG coordination initiatives that are reported under OI 2.3.2. Please note that GIZ will conduct an analysis of the capacity development questionnaires received to identify if 70% of this number trained recorded enhanced knowledge

At the **regional level**, IOM strengthened regional protection and awareness efforts through trainings (including Training of Trainers) on mental health and psychosocial support, gender-based violence, child protection, equipping frontline actors across multiple countries. It established an emergency fund, providing direct assistance to 549 migrants and returnees, comprising 267 adults and 282 children. The fund has provided various services, including interpretation support, voluntary return and reintegration, facilitation of consular and travel documentation, land and air transportation, food and non-food items, accommodation, mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS), and medical care across the BMM countries: Kenya, Uganda, Somalia, Djibouti, and Ethiopia. IOM marked World Day Against Trafficking with awareness campaigns reaching millions through media and community events. For instance, in November 2023, IOM held a three-day awareness raising workshop with participants from CSOs and government agencies in Kenya, Uganda, and Somalia. Additionally, IOM conducted a functional review of the Migration Response Centre Information System to improve migrant service delivery across four such centres: in Bossaso (Somalia), Obock (Djibouti), Hargeisa (Somalia), and Kassala (Sudan). Additionally, IOM conducted a training on the collection, analysis, and use of data for disability inclusion, focusing on its application in protection programming within the migration context.

At the **country level**, the following IOM key activities, in line with SO3, were documented:

- In **Djibouti**, IOM conducted trainings for CSOs and frontline social workers to enhance protection services for vulnerable migrants, including updating the National Referral Mechanism. Through the Djibouti Red Crescent and the IOM transit centres and satellite offices IOM also provided direct assistance to 12,030 migrants (8456 male, 1593 female), covering food, water, medical aid, hygiene, and psychosocial support.
- In **Ethiopia**, IOM promoted community engagement to address irregular migration through peer education training and the establishment of Community Conversation Groups in high-migration areas. Trainings focused on protection, law enforcement cooperation, and support for trafficking victims. IOM also facilitated the validation of a victim hotline handbook for frontline protection actors, which will be translated into Amharic, printed, and followed by a ToT and workshop. IOM is supporting the hotline's operationalization at the Ministry of Justice. Additionally, IOM strengthened capacity at the Tog Wajaale Migrant Resource Center and trained staff (a total of 48 officials) in Metema and Tog Wajaale on migrant protection. In line with the recommendations of the first Joint Border Administrators and Governors Meeting, the first Ethiopia-South Sudan Joint Border Trade Committee Meeting was held in March 2025 in Ethiopia. The meeting aimed to review the implementation status of the Border Trade Protocol and identify ways to address challenges in its execution. Finally, IOM is also developing an NRM training package, with its validation conducted in March 2025.
- In **Kenya**, IOM strengthened protection and counter-trafficking measures through trainings, several awareness campaigns, and policy development. Over 500 children and community members participated in World Day Against Trafficking events. IOM piloted community-led anti-trafficking initiatives, engaged migrant advocates, and enhanced NRM implementation. Also, IOM provided remediation guidelines for domestic migrant workers in Kenya, with the aim of offering support and redress for workers who have faced exploitation.
- In **Somalia**, IOM focused more on “leveraging internal expertise” by holding internal consultations and conducting Somali stakeholder mapping or conducting baseline surveys to roll out awareness

raising through the IOM X approach.³² To provide sustainable solutions for vulnerable youth, IOM conducted Community-Based Planning Consultations, counter-trafficking dialogues in Bossaso and Hargeisa, identifying community-driven solutions to trafficking. These efforts culminated to trainings for 60 participants in Hargeisa and Bossaso on technical and vocational education and training (TVET).

- In **South Sudan**, IOM held a workshop to raise awareness about human trafficking and conducted assessments of migrant protection services at border points, revealing gaps in GBV services and the lack of referral mechanisms for VoTs. IOM conducted 8 trainings were conducted for frontline protection actors on TiP, SoM, deploying VoT screening tools and improving case management reaching 251 participants (185 male and 66 female) across the country. IOM also facilitated voluntary return support for 25 migrants from various nationalities.
- In **Uganda**, IOM launched and handed over the National TiP Database, strengthening case management and referral for VoTs. Awareness campaigns engaged over 1,200 participants at the Uganda-South Sudan border and over 900,000 viewers through televised discussions. Trainings for first responders and border officials improved victim protection and migration governance. Additionally, IOM worked with the Ministry of Health to integrate trafficking considerations into MHPSS services.

Overall, all countries benefited from IOM activities related to SO3 under BMM Phase III, even if to a different degree. According to the results monitoring framework, four indicators were fully or partially achieved, two exceeded, and four could not be confirmed at the time of the evaluation as GIZ was noted to be responsible for the measurement of attained value (see Table 3).

Table 3: Achievement of activities under Specific Objective 3 (based on IOM documentation and as of March 18, 2025).

Specific Objective 3			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
SOI 3.1	Percentage of (potential) migrants and (potential) VoT, of which at least 40% are women and 30% are below the age of 18, confirming the provided information on safe and regular migration as useful.	80% of 600 the sample of target group members in target regions supported with communication strategies	N/A GIZ conducting endline survey
SOI 3.2	Number of male and female vulnerable migrants and victims of trafficking assisted by protection and assistance service providers involved in (national) referral mechanisms in line with international standards and gender considerations.	60,000 migrants and VoTs assisted by protection and assistance service providers	N/A GIZ will conduct a study
SOI 3.4	Number of VoT and vulnerable migrants referred to sustainable solutions (e.g. livelihood, TVET, reintegration and other suitable programmes) through supported	600 VoT and stranded migrants or returnees referred by programmes on sustainable solutions	N/A GIZ will provide the measurement of attained value

³² Annual IOM reports 2023 and 2024.

	coordination mechanisms and structures		
Output 3.1: Access to information on safe, orderly and regular migration for migrants or potential migrants is improved			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 3.1.1	Number of developed national, and cross-border migration information and communication strategies on safe, orderly, and regular migration in the region and migrants' rights.	3 national and cross border migration information and communication strategies	Partially 1 strategy
OI 3.1.2	Number of implemented information and communication strategies on safe, orderly and regular migration in the region and migrant's rights with support of BMM III	4 implemented information and communication strategies	Partially 3 implemented strategies and 1 in draft
Output 3.2: Access to protection facilities and services for victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants (incl. victims of forced labour and sexual exploitation, adults and children) is improved			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value
OI 3.2.1	Number of national and sub-national stakeholders of non-governmental and governmental institutions trained by the BMM III with increased knowledge and/or skills of the needs of vulnerable migrants and VoT (with particular focus on women and children) and their referral.	201 trained stakeholders confirm increased knowledge/skills	Exceeded 20 trainings with 561 pax
OI 3.2.2	Number of relevant state and non-governmental stakeholders confirming referrals of victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants to relevant institutions (e.g., in line with referral mechanisms, SOPs) with particular focus on women and children (incl. support to survivors of GBV or trauma).	18 relevant stakeholder institutions confirming referrals (for both IOM & GIZ)	N/A GIZ will conduct a study
OI 3.2.3	Number of local and national actors that provide improved specialised services (MHPSS, shelters, legal, health, etc.) for victims of trafficking and vulnerable migrants.	2 local and national actors that provide improved specialised services	Exceeded 3 actors
Output 3.3: Coordination mechanisms for the access to sustainable solutions for VoT and vulnerable migrants are strengthened within the region			
Indicator		Target value	Attained value

OI 3.3.1	Number of bilateral, national and local coordination platforms and/or structures between state, non-state, private sector and international stakeholders on sustainable solutions for VoT and vulnerable migrants (further) strengthened with support of BMM III.	2 bilateral national and local coordination platforms and/or structures between state, non-state and private sector and international stakeholders	Fully 2 structures in Uganda and Kenya
OI 3.3.2	Number of identified sustainable solutions for vulnerable migrants and VoT promoted at community level with the active involvement of women and youth with support of BMM III.	4 identified sustainable solutions for vulnerable migrants and VoT's in 1 BMM country	Fully 4 identified solutions in 2 Community Action Plans (1 for Hargeisa and 1 for Bossaso), Somaliland, focusing on themes such as awareness, income generation, migration governance, and youth employment

3.3.4. Factors influencing the programme's effectiveness

The evaluation identified that the implementation of IOM's activities under the BMM Programme Phase III was shaped by a combination of factors: security challenges, political dynamics, stakeholder coordination, financial constraints, and logistical hurdles. While these challenges posed significant risks to timely implementation, IOM employed adaptive strategies, stakeholder engagement, and flexible planning to maintain progress.

Security challenges

Security issues posed barriers to timely implementation across several countries. According to IOM's interim reports, in Ethiopia, the six-month state of emergency declared in August 2023 due to conflict in Amhara restricted movement, delaying activities such as Organizational Capacity Assessments (OCAs) in the region. The renovation of the Metema Border Crossing Point was delayed and subsequently cancelled due to insecurity caused by armed groups, rendering the site inaccessible. In Kenya, widespread protests disrupted the Humanitarian Border Management assessment, requiring rescheduling and enhanced risk mitigation. Similarly, in Somalia, the rollout of immigration regulations and IBMC activities faced delays due to political instability and Parliament recess. IOM addressed these challenges through risk assessments, stakeholder engagement, and flexible timelines, ensuring activities resumed when conditions allowed.

Political context and changing government priorities

Complex multi-stakeholder coordination posed challenges, particularly in countries with multiple governmental and non-governmental actors involved in migration governance. For example, in Djibouti, delays in developing the National Migration Strategy Action Plan resulted from coordination challenges, which IOM mitigated

through regular meetings and follow-ups. In Uganda, engaging trade unions, the private sector, and faith-based organizations with divergent migration governance interests required inclusive consultations to ensure the National Migration Strategy reflected diverse perspectives. In Kenya, as IOM interim report (2023) documented, the change in government in 2022 and related structural changes in the different ministries “caused delays in the implementation of activities as decision-making processes changed and there was uncertainty regarding the direction of certain Ministries”. Also, structural changes in border management institutions delayed IOM’s coordination efforts for a study tour for the Mogadishu IBMC. Furthermore, some activities in the Annual Work Plans (AWPs) required governmental approvals. As noted in the 2023 interim IOM report, this led to delays in the approval of 2023 AWPs in Djibouti, Ethiopia, and Uganda, affecting Components 1 (migration governance) and 2 (integrated border governance).³³

In other cases, delays occurred due to changing government priorities which was mentioned by the IOM staff as one of the key challenges to ensure effectiveness. Although interviewed government respondents did not highlight this challenge, the evaluation team confirmed its prevalence. In Djibouti, for instance, the implementation of MIDAS was halted due to government decisions. In Ethiopia, plans to renovate the Galafi BCP shifted in May 2023 when the government requested IOM’s assistance in Tog Wajaale BCP instead, requiring a new assessment and timeline adjustment. Hence, although government engagement was assessed by interviewees as high, reliance on national authorities sometimes caused delays in implementation.

In relation to this, legal and policy-related bottlenecks at the national level affected progress, particularly in Ethiopia and Somalia. In Ethiopia, despite advocacy efforts, the NMP remained pending Cabinet approval due to competing government priorities, leading IOM to shift its focus toward foundational migration governance activities. Similarly, in Somalia, delays in codifying immigration regulations into law necessitated timeline adjustments and ongoing engagement with policymakers to maintain momentum.

Contractual constraints

The delayed signing of the BMM III contract between IOM and GIZ in April 2023 meant that activity implementation could not start from the project start date during October 2022. Once signed, this required the development of a catch-up plan to prioritize the delayed activities at both regional and country levels. In turn, the delay slowed down the roll out of planned activities at the beginning of Phase III and had implication on budgetary burn rates at later stages (see Section 4.1.1. for more details on budgetary implications of this delay and further financial efficiency). A similar contractual issue was also reported by other implementing partners.

Procurement challenges

Various disruptions in procurement processes caused delays in the roll out of activities in different countries. This was mentioned as a challenge by all interviewee groups – IOM staff, government respondents, and civil society organizations. Some of these procurement challenges related to internal IOM procurement processes, while others were external, including challenges with procuring items on the local market:

- In December 2024, a planned internal IOM system change (to WAVE) experienced technical issues, thereby creating some procurement delays in early 2025: “We had to freeze all procurement for a month... then start quickly again, which caused delays.”
- In Kenya, “delays in procuring equipment and materials and the need to comply with specific guidelines” impacted “the timely execution of several activities” (IOM interim report 2024).

³³ However, approvals for the 2024 and 2025 AWPs did not face this challenge.

- In Uganda, “requests for additional digital screens and extended procurement processes” caused delays in procuring digital screens for awareness campaigns (IOM interim report 2024). IOM addressed this by conducting a mapping exercise to determine needs and streamline the procurement process.
- In Djibouti, the E-Visa system and coastguard equipment procurement were delayed, requiring IOM to conduct assessments, identify priority border points, and adjust procurement timelines.
- In Somalia, “delays in codifying the immigration regulations into law and the reconvening of Parliament from recess, necessitated adjustments in the rollout timelines for the Immigration Act and related training sessions, complicating the planning and implementation of these activities” (IOM interim report 2024).

A general perception among national respondents was that “their [IOM’s] procurement is very slow”. Although some of the delays related to factors external to IOM, they pose a reputational risk for IOM. In Somalia, for instance, the mentioned delays in trainings were perceived by one government respondent as an issue of IOM’s “internal procurement process”³⁴ – even if the actual reasons for delay might have been more complex. Similarly, a government respondent recalled delays in the pay out of Daily Subsistence Allowances (DSA) to participants of a training that the government co-organized: “There was a time when we brought people for training. We brought them from the regions, and we put them in hotels... Once the time came when their DSA was supposed to be paid, there were really delays. It fell on a weekend, [IOM] said... This made us look bad in front of the people who travelled from the regions [and did not get reimbursed on time].”

Enabling factors – adaptive management, regular stakeholder engagement, and cordial relationships

Key enabling factors included regular stakeholder engagement, adaptive planning and management, and securing additional funding sources, which showcased IOM's resilience and flexibility, allowing progress despite challenging operating environments. Consider, for instance, the National Partnership Coalition assessments in Ethiopia which were initially scheduled for three regions. However, due to budget constraints and logistical challenges, the focus was narrowed to two regions: Oromia and Amhara. While the scope of the activity was narrowed down, it was done strategically considering these regions' proximity to Addis Ababa, allowing for more efficient use of resources and better coordination. Furthermore, several interviewees referred to the importance of strong professional relationships which have been established over the years between the different partner entities and organizations. Such cordial relationships allowed navigating above-mentioned challenges more efficiently, thereby contributing to the achievement of programme’s objectives.

For instance, although one civil society organization experienced issues due to procurement delays on the IOM’s side (transition to the new WAVE system), the national partner was briefed and informed and thus showed understanding and overall satisfaction with the relationship:

“We have had some instances where the procurement process took some time... but of course we ironed out that out with them and they promised to improve... The cooperation overall was fine... it has been great cooperating with them [IOM], working with them and they are trying to do their best.”

Overall, IOM’s ability to navigate security risks, coordination challenges, financial constraints, procurement delays, and policy bottlenecks was crucial for ensuring the continued implementation of BMM activities.

³⁴ Interview with a national government respondent.

3.3.5. Integration of cross-cutting themes

IOM demonstrated varying degrees of integration of cross-cutting themes in its design, implementation, and reporting. **Gender and human rights** considerations were well integrated through targeted training sessions, victim protection initiatives, and capacity-building efforts. For example, IOM conducted Gender-Based Violence risk mitigation and response training, ensuring that frontline protection actors were equipped to identify and support victims. Additionally, the programme incorporated human rights principles in counter-trafficking efforts, focusing on victim-centered approaches, legal protections, and case management for VoTs.

The programme also addressed **peace and security** by strengthening border management mechanisms and regional cooperation. The establishment and operationalization of IBMCs, combined with cross-border coordination meetings and study tours, contributed to enhanced migration governance and security frameworks. **Participatory development** and **good governance** were promoted through multi-stakeholder consultations and policy development support, particularly in Uganda and Ethiopia. However, the integration of poverty orientation and migration and **climate change** was less pronounced, with limited direct programming addressing climate-induced migration or economic drivers of irregular migration.

3.4. EFFICIENCY

The efficiency section comprises an analysis of the functioning of the IOM activities in terms of use of available resources, capacity to mobilize resources, and its efficiency of management and monitoring.

3.4.1. Financial efficiency of IOM's BMM programme

Overall, IOM's BMM Phase III faced initial delays, leading to accelerated spending in the final months, with 56% of the €9.86 million budget spent by September 2024. While no negative consequences were found, this dynamic posed risks for strategic planning and implementation. Despite staffing disparities and resource limitations relative to migrant needs, cost-sharing improved efficiency, and IOM expected full budget utilization by March 2025.

IOM's BMM component under Phase III received a total budget of € 9,855,083. By September 2024, financial reporting shows that 56% of the budget had been spent.³⁵ The need to spend almost half of the allocated budget (44%) in the last six months (of the total 28 months) created pressure on IOM to make sure the budget will be used entirely (see Figure 3).

As one IOM staff member put it: *"Our implementation started in April 2023... and we are now racing towards the end to finalize spending."*³⁶ Another national IOM colleague also mentioned that *"the pressure is there [and] we are doing everything within our capacity to ensure that by [end of Phase III] everything is delivered."*

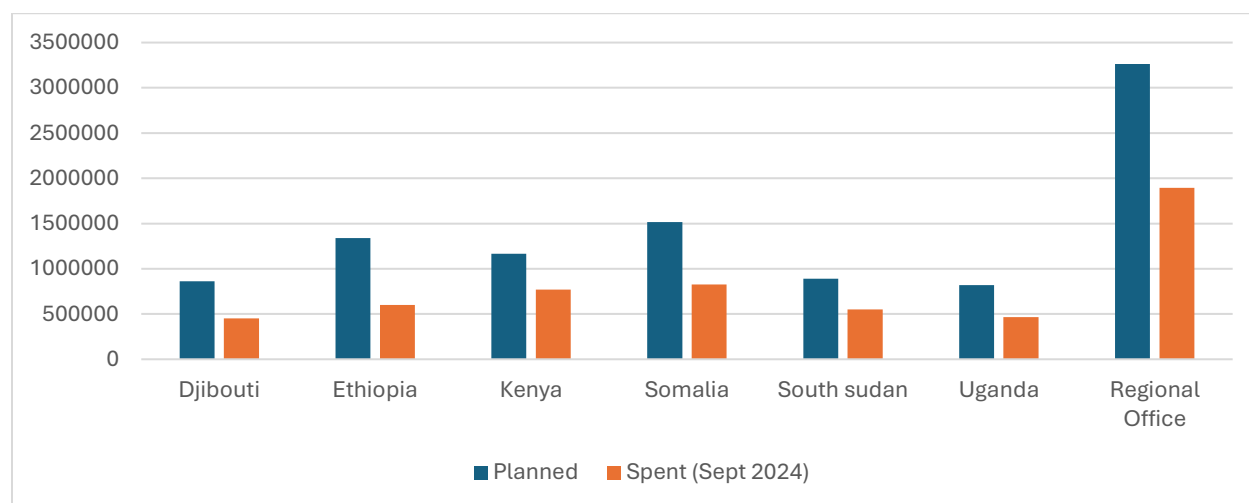
This is not a new dynamic: already under Phase II, the IOM's internal evaluation report noted that "there were delays in implementing activities during the first half of the programme which resulted in low burn rate and

³⁵ Summary of expenses per Output per country, provided by IOM.

³⁶ Interview with IOM staff.

low activity completion rate.”³⁷ Specifically, under Phase II, 38% of the budget was spent after 22 months (in comparison to 56% under Phase III).

Figure 3. Budget and spending across the BMM countries and Regional Office (RO) as of September 2024 (based on financial documentation provided by IOM)



IOM staff explained this referring to contractual delays at the beginning of Phase III (signing the contract between IOM and GIZ), national stakeholder engagement as well as limited resources of IOM country offices: “IOM is operating in very, very vulnerable places. At the missions’ level, the capacities are very low. In combination with slow responses from the governments, this creates delays”.

To be sure, the evaluation team did not find evidence for negative consequences of such budgetary dynamics. Nevertheless, the need to rapidly increase the burn rate towards the end of a phase naturally creates risks for strategic, coordinated planning and implementation.

By the time of data collection and analysis (February 2025), IOM staff across the six countries reported that activities had either been completed or were almost completed. Most IOM BMM focal points also reported that the budget will be used entirely by the end of the Phase III (March 2025).

Although more can always be done with more funding, interviewed IOM staff were generally satisfied with the allocation of financial resources, as they were aligned with the planned activities.³⁸ Some examples were provided of top-ups received during Phase III, e.g. for the response to returnees, refugees or Third Country Nationals from Sudan. Furthermore, different IOM offices provided examples of cost-sharing, either through shared activities with other IOM projects, or with other BMM partners.³⁹

*“We were organising an activity in the region for BMM. Because we were able to cost-share the activity with another IOM project, we were able to gather many more participants and therefore make the activity more impactful than if we had only used the BMM budget. Of course, the costs were still reported separately to avoid conflicts with the donors”.*⁴⁰

³⁷ Internal final evaluation of the project “Better Migration Management Phase II” (2022), p. 21.

³⁸ Interviews with IOM staff

³⁹ Interviews with IOM staff

⁴⁰ Interview with IOM staff

“We have saved some amount because another project contributed to the activity as well, namely conference room renting. The savings have been shifted to another urgent, prioritized activity where we had less funding”.⁴¹

Three **challenges** regarding resources were highlighted⁴²:

- Firstly, the staffing differed among the programme countries. While in Kenya, Phase III was implemented by three dedicated specialists (one per component), the BMM in South Sudan was implemented by two project assistants, which created a high workload and complications in terms of decision-making (support and approval from the RO was necessary). Other IOM teams also mentioned that they needed to rely on staff from other projects or that the workload was quite high for them.
- Secondly, while the resources aligned with the activities, the needs and volume of migrants vastly exceeded the scope of the programme. To support all vulnerable migrants, and address all their needs more holistically, vastly more resources would be needed.
- Finally, interview partners both within and outside IOM referred to the inconsistencies related to **Daily Subsistence Allowance** rates and procedures across different implementing partners in each country (apart from Kenya where the UN has harmonised DSA rates with the Government of Kenya), leading to varying allowances for participants. This lack of standardization sometimes created confusion and dissatisfaction, particularly when some allowances were too low to cover actual costs, such as transportation, or were perceived as too high and distorting reasons for stakeholder engagement. Additionally, DSA disbursement procedures when relatively large sums of cash were withdrawn and distributed at conference venues were flagged as security and efficiency concern. This issue was addressed by providing DSA prior to and after temporary duty, ensuring a more secure and efficient disbursement process while minimizing risks associated with handling large amounts of cash on-site. Another measure that could be taken is providing reduced DSA by arranging accommodation and meals directly, which would further enhanced financial security and administrative efficiency.

3.4.2. Efficiency of coordination and reporting

Effective coordination was a critical aspect of BMM Phase III, ensuring synergy between IOM’s internal operations and its collaboration with external partners. While IOM maintained structured coordination mechanisms at both national and regional levels, challenges persisted for IOM in achieving a fully integrated approach across all implementing partners across different countries. Reporting processes were clear and well managed.

In terms of **internal coordination** among IOM staff, activities under BMM Phase III were managed by IOM’s Regional Office for the EHoA BMM management team, through a combination of structured meetings, online collaboration tools, and engagement with national offices. IOM held regular biweekly coordination meetings between the Regional Office and each country office to monitor programme activities and ensure alignment with the overarching objectives.⁴³ These management and coordination efforts were led by the Senior and Deputy Regional Programme Managers, backed by a team based at IOM’s Regional Office for East, Horn, and

⁴¹ Interview with IOM staff

⁴² Interviews with IOM staff

⁴³ For instance, a planning workshop in May 2023 brought together regional and national offices to share insights and address coordination challenges.

Southern Africa in Nairobi. Focal points were placed within the BMM countries, forming a distributed network that ensures IOM can adapt to the specific needs of each area. Additionally, the programme benefits from the expertise of experienced senior managers at both regional and country levels, who provide valuable insights and support to drive the programme's continued success. The majority of IOM staff were satisfied with this coordination structure, while some national IOM staff suggested that internal coordination could be further improved through enhanced **information sharing across different country teams**. Overall, interviews with IOM staff unanimously showed high appreciation for the support of the RO to the country offices.

As one interviewed staff member summarized it: *"I would say the support was fantastic. In terms of budget support, in terms of technical support, coordination with GIZ, the team was really, really helpful."*

In terms of **external coordination**, BMM Phase III required cooperation with other implementing partners, donors, and national governments. All implementing partners (at the regional level) were meeting twice a year through a Steering Committee in Brussels and at the national level in each country monthly (apart from South Sudan which is missing that structure); these meetings were chaired and led by GIZ. Similarly to the internal coordination, some interviewees also mentioned the need for country office staff from different partner organizations to meet with each other.

One interviewee noted: *"I do not know if [implementing partners] have ever all sat together, you know, to discuss BMM, and I mean all countries together. This could be done online... It does not have to be a super big event, just an exchange."*

In this regard, IOM worked alongside all BMM **implementing partners**, although to a different degree. IOM and UNODC maintained a clear division of labor, with UNODC focusing on legal frameworks and criminal justice, while IOM concentrated on victim protection and migration governance. One interviewee explained: "UNODC developed a curriculum on trafficking in persons for the National School of the Judiciary, while [IOM] trained stakeholders on victim identification and referral." Collaboration with CIVIPOL seemed to have improved over time, particularly in areas such as multi-agency simulations and training programs. Coordination with the British Council was less extensive, as their focus on community engagement differed from IOM's policy-level work. One interviewee highlighted this distinction: "[British Council] activities are distinct and complement each other. IOM works more on the higher policy level, while British Council focuses more on community engagement."

While **joint activities** were conducted, some interviewees noted that the **monthly coordination meetings** chaired by GIZ in all countries except South Sudan were primarily used for information sharing rather than strategic planning. One stakeholder suggested: "the monthly coordination meetings [chaired by GIZ]... could be a forum where there is also some discussion on the contents and some initiatives for joint planning." For instance, an interviewee suggested that partners could better coordinate their activities in terms of implementation locations: "If we agree on the selection of the region, that would amplify the result, the impact because IOM works with the government, and we work with the community." Some interviewees also noted that coordination between partners was sometimes more efficient when organizations met separately to address specific issues or common activities bilaterally.

Another challenge in external coordination was the **differing project timelines** among implementing partners. Some organizations had different start and end dates for their Phase III activities, leading to challenges in planning and aligning for joint initiatives.

Coordination with GIZ was complex due to its dual role as both a grant provider and an implementing partner. This dual function led to role ambiguity, as GIZ oversaw other implementing partners while also running its own activities, sometimes risking having overlapping responsibilities and parallel structures with IOM. Also, some interviewees mentioned that the lack of country-level GIZ coordinators in South Sudan complicated collaboration. Despite these challenges, importantly, both GIZ and IOM maintained a close and professional relationship, described by interviewees on both sides as “cordial”, “appreciated”, “very cooperative”, and “smooth” – something which ultimately helped navigating the relationship and avoid inefficiencies.

Finally, IOM has established an efficient and structured **monitoring and reporting system** under the BMM programme, ensuring regular tracking of progress and challenges to adhere to the heavy reporting requirements. Reporting requirements were described by IOM staff and implementing partners as “very straightforward”, with interim reports proving useful in documenting key achievements and identifying implementation challenges. The log frame was strengthened by IOM following the start of the project to connect programme outputs and activities to Annual Work Plans. Noteworthy, a stronger integration of qualitative assessments, including beneficiary perspectives, could enhance the depth of analysis. Although quantitative indicators provide valuable insights, they may not fully capture the programme's broader, long-term impact. Additionally, while the IOM digital platform ‘Sharepoint’ is beneficial for document management, ensuring that all staff utilise it remains a challenge. Nonetheless, IOM’s emphasis on systematic data collection and accessible reporting structures has strengthened programme oversight and adaptive management.

3.5. IMPACT

The following section assesses to what extent the BMM programme (Phase III) implemented by IOM has made progress towards its overall objective, and whether further impact can be expected in the upcoming years. To be sure, evaluating *impact*, which focuses on the broader, long-term effects of an intervention, presents methodological challenges, as the evaluation design did not include field visits and direct engagement with further beneficiaries (migrants). Therefore, the impact assessment is limited and rather focused on the progress IOM made towards the overall objective of the BMM and the potential that this progress will prevail at the higher outcome level.

The intended impact of the BMM Programme Phase III according to its Theory of Change was to create a sustainable and well-managed (“safe, orderly and regular”) migration environment in the EHoA region. This was to be achieved through the three key components: enhanced migration governance, effective institutions and improved cross-border cooperation, and protection of vulnerable migrants.

IOM has made substantial positive contributions to strengthening migration governance, border management, and migrant protection across the region. By enhancing governance frameworks, fostering cross-border cooperation, improving protection mechanisms, raising awareness, and building institutional capacity, IOM activities have contributed to safer, more orderly, and regular migration.

The collected evaluation data confirms significant contributions that were made by IOM to improving migration governance, border management, and migrant protection in the region. While the long-term impact remains challenging to fully assess, the available evidence highlights meaningful progress towards the programme’s objectives.

First, the evaluation team confirmed that IOM's support has led to tangible **improvements in national migration policies and institutional frameworks**. Countries such as Ethiopia, Kenya, and Somalia have developed or refined policies aligned with international standards (e.g., the Global Compact for Migration), fostering a more structured approach to migration management. These policies, developed with the support of IOM, are likely to create “spill-over” effects leading to further development of legislative acts on migration. Highlighting the IOM's role in shaping migration governance, a national government interviewee explained: “the National Migration Policy framework... will be the document that guides the formulation of other policies in [the country]”.

Importantly, IOM activities have **strengthened government commitment** to addressing migration challenges, as one national stakeholder noted: “The new directives and laws have strengthened the government's commitment to regular migration and improved coordination among relevant actors.” Another national government representative emphasized: “The biggest win for the program... is that you can see that the topic of migration management is really being seen at a high level.”

Second, some of the IOM activities **strengthened cross-border cooperation**, for instance, through initiatives like the establishment of IBMCs and the implementation of the MIDAS. These efforts have contributed to a better coordination and efficiency of border management, reducing the risks associated with irregular migration and enhancing the security and protection of migrants.

Finally, IOM has contributed to the **protection of vulnerable migrants**, for instance, through the support to migrant response centres, capacity-building initiatives, the development of NRMs, and the provision of direct assistance. The latter was very much appreciated, as one government stakeholder emphasized: “*IOM is very good in direct assistance to migrants. They have migrant response centres and other tools.*”

The programme's **awareness-raising campaigns** and **community engagement** initiatives have played a crucial role in potentially changing attitudes and behaviors towards migration. Activities like the Community Conversation Facilitators Training in Ethiopia and the Migrants as Messengers initiative in Kenya have empowered communities to address migration challenges proactively. These efforts have increased awareness of the risks associated with irregular migration and the available support mechanisms, contributing to safer migration practices. Training sessions, for instance, on MHPSS, GBV, risk mitigation, and child protection have strengthened frontline workers' skills needed to support and protect migrants effectively. One national partner noted, however, that longer-term assignments are needed for awareness-raising campaigns (more than three-four months) to have larger impact.

Overall, IOM has laid the groundwork for long-term improvements in migration and border governance, although, as outlined in the next section, there are concerns about the sustainability of these achievements without continued support.

3.6. SUSTAINABILITY

The sustainability criterion measures the extent to which the results and achievements of the IOM's activities under the Phase III of the BMM programme are likely to be sustained long-term and after the completion of the programme.

While IOM contributed to the institutionalization of migration management and increased national actors' capacities, sustainability challenges remain. Continued financial support, national ownership, and long-term commitment from governments are necessary to ensure the durability of

programme achievements. The transition to BMM Phase IV presents both an opportunity to reinforce sustainability measures and a risk of losing progress if gaps in funding and staffing are not addressed.

Efforts to **institutionalize migration management** have been a key component of BMM Phase III, with policies and frameworks being embedded into national strategies. Several governments, including Kenya and Somalia, have demonstrated commitment to sustaining these reforms. One government representative noted: “We knew that after this program, we will be taking actions and doing a good job with IOM.” Similarly, an official from another country stated: “We are exploring the possibility of getting government funding for the directorate activities... we can continue supporting the objectives of BMM.”

To ensure sustainability, IOM has invested in **training government personnel and institutions**, equipping them with the skills needed to manage migration independently. However, while capacity has improved, many governments lack the financial resources to maintain these efforts without continued external support. As one national stakeholder stated: “*For the national partners, it would be really difficult to continue carrying and supporting activities related to life-saving assistance or migration management overall.*” This raises concerns about long-term sustainability, particularly in resource-constrained countries like Somalia, South Sudan, and Djibouti.

Hence, the **reliance of national actors on project-based** funding poses a **risk** to sustainability. In some cases, government officials depend on BMM funds for salaries, which is not viable in the long run. As one stakeholder observed: “BMM has been a huge source of support for these national governments... but they were wondering how the gap that is being left will be filled.” The programme’s sustainability would be strengthened by fostering greater government financial commitment and introducing co-funding principles. This is also understood by several interviewed government officials. As one national government respondent summarized: “For sustainability, we are in a good track, but the next phase of BMM should focus on government ownership and resource allocation.” One interviewee proposed a “two-thirds principle” after three years of funding for the same project, suggesting that governments could assume the majority of the programme's budget after this period.

The evaluation team identifies a significant risk to sustainability due to the gap between the end of IOM activities under BMM Phase III (March 2025) and the anticipated start of Phase IV in late 2025. While Phase IV is expected to enhance the sustainability of achieved objectives, interviewees emphasized that its focus will be on implementing and strengthening existing policies rather than developing new ones. However, past transitions between BMM phases have led to staff turnover and implementation delays, disrupting continuity. Several stakeholders expressed concerns that the funding gap between Phase III and Phase IV could result in staff lay-offs, posing a major risk to sustainability by leading to the loss of institutional memory and weakening well-established relationships and partnerships built by current IOM staff.

Furthermore, the evaluation team highlights a **significant risk** to sustainability due to the **gap between the end of IOM activities under BMM Phase III (March 2025) and the anticipated start of Phase IV** in late 2025. The planned Phase IV will likely contribute to increased sustainability of achieved objectives. As some interviewees noted, the focus for Phase IV will be on implementing and building on existing policies rather than developing new ones to ensure the sustainability of already established achievements. However, past transitions between BMM phases have led to staff turnover and implementation delays, disrupting continuity. In turn, several stakeholders expressed concerns that the funding gap between Phase III and Phase IV could result in staff lay-offs, posing a major risk to sustainability by leading to the loss of institutional memory and

weakening well-established relationships and partnerships built by current IOM staff. One implementing partner, facing a similar situation, described this uncertainty as their “biggest concern.”

4. CONCLUSIONS

The evaluation found that IOM activities under the BMM Phase III programme were **highly relevant** to the needs of the target countries and their stakeholders. The programme effectively addressed key migration challenges in the East and Horn of Africa region, including irregular migration, human trafficking, and weak institutional capacities. National officials and stakeholders widely acknowledged IOM’s contributions, particularly in shaping migration policies, strengthening border management, and providing direct assistance to vulnerable migrants.

The programme was largely **effective in achieving its expected objectives**. IOM successfully supported the development and revision of national migration policies, enhanced cross-border cooperation, and improved protection services for vulnerable migrants. Government officials credited IOM with elevating migration governance as a priority issue. IOM activities remained largely **aligned with the programme’s initial design**, though adjustments had to be made to reflect shifting government priorities and further challenges such as procurement delays and security issues in some countries which hindered full implementation. Nevertheless, IOM met or exceeded most programme targets and the programme’s flexible approach enabled IOM to reallocate resources and modify activities as needed.

The **effective coordination and management** of BMM Phase III by IOM’s Regional Office for the East and Horn of Africa played a crucial role in ensuring the smooth implementation of programme activities across multiple countries. A well-organized approach, supported by focal points in each BMM country, allowed IOM to remain responsive to the specific needs of different operational contexts while benefiting from the expertise of experienced managers at both regional and country levels. The programme demonstrated **adaptability to evolving contexts**, such as the conflict in Sudan and Somalia’s accession to the East African Community, ensuring its continued relevance.

IOM activities under BMM Phase III demonstrated strong **internal coherence** by leveraging synergies with other IOM projects or frameworks, such as the Regional Migrant Response Plan, enabling cost-sharing and expanded reach. Externally, IOM collaborated with **BMM implementing partners** UNODC, GIZ, CIVIPOL, and the British Council. While some joint activities were undertaken to create synergies, external coordination remained primarily under GIZ’s responsibility. Its dual role as both grant provider and implementing partner added complexity to communication and planning, but active engagement and a cooperative relationship between GIZ and the IOM Regional Office helped mitigate potential challenges.

From an efficiency perspective, **IOM managed its resources effectively** despite initial delays in programme implementation, which led to increased **spending pressure** in later phases. Cost-sharing with other IOM projects helped maximize impact, but **procurement challenges**, including internal system transitions and security concerns, also delayed some activities. Nevertheless, IOM’s structured monitoring and reporting systems ensured accountability and adaptive management, though qualitative assessments could be better integrated to capture broader programme impacts.

While BMM Phase III has made tangible progress, **long-term sustainability remains a key concern**. The programme helped institutionalize migration management structures and build national capacities, but financial

dependence on donor funding poses a risk to sustaining these achievements. Government commitment to continuing migration governance efforts was noted, but securing national budget allocations remains a challenge. The transition to BMM Phase IV presents both an opportunity to reinforce sustainability and a risk of setbacks if funding and staffing gaps arise between phases. Moving forward, greater national ownership and co-funding mechanisms will be critical to ensuring that the programme's achievements endure beyond donor support.

In terms of **lessons learned**, the evaluation found that **adaptive management** style was crucial for IOM to successfully adjusted to evolving migration dynamics, such as shifting government priorities or evolving conflicts. It was necessary to have mechanisms in place for rapid response to emerging migration trends by reflecting whole of routes approach, for instance, through established contingency funds that allow for swift resource reallocation in response to political or security developments. This might, however, be more challenging during BMM Phase IV considering its lower budget and potentially stricter scope. Furthermore, **community engagement** works best when it is **long-term**: short-term awareness campaigns had limited impact on behavioral change. Also, **digital data platforms** (both GIZ data platform and IOM online Sharepoint) improved monitoring and coordination and using technology for tracking migration trends enhanced data quality. Finally, maintaining cooperative, **cordial relationships with implementing partners' staff** proved to be an effective strategy for better inter-agency collaboration.

5. RECOMMENDATIONS

Following the findings and conclusions of the evaluation, the following recommendations have been developed to foster learning enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, and sustainability of IOM's interventions under future phases of the BMM Programme and beyond.

Recommendation 1: Maintain a strong internal coordination structure and retain qualified staff to ensure efficiency and effective implementation of activities under BMM Phase IV

The current management structure has proven essential in overseeing multi-country implementation, enabling responsiveness to evolving contexts, and leveraging the expertise of regional and country-level managers. Given BMM IV's core objective of strengthening regional cooperation, strategic management from the Regional Office is essential. This positioning enables IOM to engage more effectively with key regional organizations and processes such as IGAD, the African Union, ECA, and the Khartoum Process, ensuring alignment with broader regional migration governance frameworks. In addition, the Regional Office is uniquely placed to coordinate cross-border and regional initiatives, foster synergies across participating countries, and ensure the inclusion of Uganda (which will no longer be an independent participating country under BMM IV) through regional engagement and activities that transcend national boundaries. Hence, to sustain achieved outcomes and ensure efficiency and effectiveness during BMM Phase IV, the evaluation team recommends to:

- Keep the **Regional Office as the primary coordination and management** hub for BMM Phase IV, while maintaining focal points in each BMM country to ensure localized responsiveness and effective implementation.

Recommendation 2: Enhance internal cross-country cooperation and synergies with implementing partners

Internal coordination can be further strengthened by enhancing communication between country offices:

- Strengthen information-sharing and cooperation **across different country teams**, for instance, by having monthly or quarterly online meetings with all country teams and Regional Office.

Externally, IOM and partners could move beyond information-sharing meetings to more strategic planning sessions, as coordinated by GIZ the lead implementing partner, also ensuring cross-country cooperation:

- Some stakeholders noted that monthly coordination meetings chaired by GIZ focused primarily on updates rather than substantive collaboration. To optimize coordination (when needed), these meetings could incorporate **action-oriented discussions** on joint activities (such as multi-agency simulations and joint training programs), geographic alignment of activities, and opportunities for shared resources.
- Additionally, **smaller, thematic working groups** among implementing partners could be introduced to allow for more targeted collaboration and problem-solving (when needed). This can be proposed on an ad-hoc basis.
- **Cross-country exchanges** could be organized more frequently to facilitate knowledge-sharing and best practices.

- The **dual role of GIZ** as both a grant provider and an implementer has, at times, created ambiguities and complicated implementation. To mitigate this, clearer lines of communication and responsibilities could be outlined at the outset of Phase IV. This could include designating separate focal points responsible for implementation and those responsible for grant- or donor-related aspects.
- Also, reviewing coordination mechanisms at the country level in locations where GIZ does not have dedicated BMM coordinators might help improve collaboration.

Recommendation 3: Ensure continuity between BMM programme phases

One of the risks identified in the evaluation is the **gap between the end of BMM Phase III and the start of Phase IV**, which could lead to staffing disruptions and loss of institutional memory and programmatic momentum. To mitigate this:

- Transition plans should be developed to **maintain core programme personnel** and ensure continuity in operations. Additionally, donors should consider allowing carry-over of funds and approving no-cost extensions to ensure continuity, while also committing to multi-year funding to enhance predictability and stability in program delivery. Lessons from previous transitions between BMM phases indicate that minimizing staff turnover is essential for maintaining established partnerships and ensuring smooth implementation.
- If possible, GIZ and implementing partners should **align their implementation timelines** under Phase IV to avoid missed opportunities for joint actions and enhance sustainability.
- Based on Phase II and III experience, IOM should **anticipate** contractual delays and changing national priorities during BMM Phase IV and plan its **budgetary spending** accordingly, to prevent last-minute spending pressures and risks of unspent funds at the end of the programme.

Recommendation 4: Strengthen procurement and financial coordination to streamline processes and prevent delays

To mitigate procurement-related delays and enhance the efficiency of project implementation, IOM should adopt a proactive and structured approach to procurement planning and coordination. While some delays stem from external factors, improving internal processes and coordination mechanisms can help reduce bottlenecks and ensure smoother implementation. The following actions are recommended:

- **Clarify roles and responsibilities** within IOM at regional and mission level for procurement related submissions and approvals that are not reflected in IOM procurement guidelines.
- Develop and share a **procurement plan** at project inception to enhance coordination and foresight. This will ensure early awareness of upcoming procurement needs and facilitate timely processing.
- During the contracting phase with GIZ and other partners, clearly define and agree on any **alternative procurement procedures** to streamline decision-making and avoid delays due to procedural mismatches.
- To the extent possible, procurement requests should be initiated **early in the project cycle**, particularly for items known to have longer processing times, to prevent last-minute disruptions.
- To manage expectations and maintain trust, IOM should proactively **communicate procurement timelines and potential delays** with government stakeholders and implementing partners. This will help address concerns over perceived inefficiencies and safeguard IOM's reputation.

- Improve **contingency planning for system transitions**. Lessons learned from the late 2024 system transition (to WAVE) indicate the need for contingency measures to minimize operational disruptions during system upgrades. Future transitions should include clear mitigation strategies to prevent procurement freezes.
- To prevent issues such as delayed DSA payouts, particularly over weekends or public holidays, **digital financial solutions** should be explored to enable timely reimbursements and reduce reliance on manual cash transactions, particularly in contexts where handling cash presents safety concerns. In relation to this, a **standardized approach towards DSA rates** across partners should be adopted, drawing on best practices such as Kenya's harmonized donor principles despite resentment expressed by participants.

Recommendation 5: Strengthen national ownership, commitment, and capacities

To ensure the sustainability of migration governance efforts, national governments should increase their ownership and commitment to key programme activities. This could include both financial commitments and support with personnel. Many countries remain heavily dependent on external funding, which risks programmatic disruptions when donor support ends. IOM (together with other implementing partners) could:

- Encourage participating states to take greater ownership of the programme's activities by introducing a **co-funding principle** where governments commit to gradually take over financial responsibilities after an initial donor-funded period.
- In terms of communication with national stakeholders, some interviewees suggested that **formal communication channels** i.e. through official letters could be strengthened to ensure timely and clear communication of changes and updates, potentially reducing delays in implementation.
- Develop transition plans and **exit strategies** to outline clear steps for continued policy implementation beyond donor-supported programmes.

In addition, capacity-building initiatives under BMM Phase III have proven effective in strengthening national migration institutions. To ensure long-term sustainability:

- Trainings could be **embedded within national institutions** such as law enforcement and standardized training programs could be developed to institutionalize knowledge transfer.
- The **Training of Trainers approach** could be expanded to equip stakeholders with the necessary tools and knowledge to effectively pass on the training to others.
- **Mentorship and peer-learning opportunities**, such as the Ethiopia-Kenya study tour on border management, could be expanded to foster cross-country learning.

Recommendation 6: For BMM Phase IV, finalize ongoing policy processes and consolidate established activities instead of starting new lengthy initiatives, ensuring regional and cross-border initiatives are prioritized

Considering that BMM Phase IV will likely be the last phase of the BMM programme, it is crucial to consolidate and build upon the achievements made in previous phases. The focus should be on implementing and enhancing existing policies rather than initiating new processes. For instance:

- Further working on **national migration policies** that IOM supported in drafting, and which require further assistance for finalization and adoption (such as Ethiopian national migration policy).
- Further institutionalizing **National Referral Mechanisms** to ensure they are operational, with sustainable funding mechanisms and clear guidelines for regional and cross-border case referrals
- Further strengthening the Inter-Agency Border Management Committees and other **cross-border cooperation mechanisms** and enhancing their sustainability through advocating for national budgetary allocations and co-financing mechanisms.